

DELHI PLUGS IN 200 E-BUSES, FLEET CROSSES 5,000 **P3**



CONG TO TAKE 'PAPER-LEAK' FIGHT TO GRASSROOTS **P5**

'IT FELT LIKE A BIG FILM WITH GREAT POSSIBILITIES' **P12**



3 dead, 3 injured after truck's CNG cylinder explodes



PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 19

Three people were killed and three others injured after a CNG cylinder of a truck exploded while it was being refilled at a filling station near Tikri Kalan Metro Station in outer Delhi on Wednesday afternoon, triggering panic in the area and prompting the deployment of six fire tenders, police said. All three deceased were employees of the filling station.

The incident took place around 3.20 pm, when CNG was being filled into the truck. Police said six people were near the vehicle at the time of the explosion. Manish, 25, who was filling the gas, died at the spot. Sunny, 30, and Brahmjeet, 34, later died of their injuries. The three deceased were identified as residents of West Delhi and Nizampur. **CONTINUED ON P4**

Gor: J&K important part of India, US may review travel advisory

Gor's visit is the first standalone US envoy trip since Article 370's abrogation

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
Srinagar, August 19

In a strong endorsement of India's longstanding position on Jammu and Kashmir, US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor on Wednesday called the Union Territory "an important part of India" during his first visit to Kashmir Valley.

Gor's significant remark came after he met Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah, marking the first standalone trip by a US envoy to the Union Territory since the abrogation of Article 370 in August 2019 and after last year's terror attack in Pahalgam.

"It is a pleasure to be here... This is an important part of India. I am here, visiting for the first time. It is an incredibly beautiful place. I am thrilled to be here, thrilled to see this place," an ecstatic Gor said. The remark by Gor at a joint media briefing with Omar Abdullah is being seen as an endorsement of India's stated position that J&K is an inalienable and inte-



» PAKISTAN CRIES FOUL, SUMMONS US CHARGÉ D'AFFAIRES

gral part of the country amid Pakistan's repeated misadventures in the region.

The US envoy also asserted that the US would reconsider downgrading its highest-level

travel warning for J&K. Presently, the US has a Level 4 "do not travel" advisory for J&K due to terrorism concerns. He said he had "a very warm, very cordial" meeting with the Chief

KEY POINTS

- » Gor said Washington may reconsider its J&K travel advisory
- » J&K currently carries America's highest Level 4, travel warning
- » The US advisory cites terrorism concerns and advises Americans against travel
- » Gor said America periodically reviews its travel warnings
- » He cited improved safety conditions across the region
- » Gor said Americans would enjoy Kashmir's beauty and opportunities
- » Gor described his meeting with Abdullah as warm and cordial
- » Abdullah said talks focused on US engagement with Jammu and Kashmir
- » Abdullah said some legacy issues would be resolved over time

SIGNALS POSSIBLE RATE HIKE RBI Governor flags inflation risks

MPPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 19



Sanjay Malhotra

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is waiting for clearer evidence on the direction and persistence of inflation before changing its policy rate, Governor Sanjay Malhotra said, while cautioning that a broad-based rise in food, fuel and other input costs could eventually require monetary tightening. His comments came as the six-member Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) unanimously decided to keep the benchmark repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent for a fourth consecutive meeting.

The MPC met from August 3 to 5 amid heightened global uncertainty, supply-chain disruptions linked to the conflict in West Asia, volatile energy prices and an erratic monsoon. Minutes of the meeting, released on Wednesday, showed broad agreement among members that food and fuel prices posed risks, but there was still limited

evidence that these pressures had spread across the wider economy.

Malhotra said the central bank should wait for more information on actual inflation readings, forecasts and the level at which inflation is likely to normalise before recalibrating the policy rate. He said monetary policy would need to respond to a supply-side shock if it resulted in a generalisation of inflation, persistent price pressures or a de-anchoring of inflation expectations. So far, he said, evidence of such developments remained limited.

"Any evidence of these risks materialising may need **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Cabinet clears Rs 13,041 crore infra projects

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved infrastructure projects worth Rs 13,041 crore, including four railway multitracking works costing Rs 9,450 crore and an Rs 3,591-crore four-lane corridor connecting Muzaffarpur, Sitamarhi and Sonbarsa in Bihar. The railway projects will expand capacity on high-density routes, improve freight movement and connect industrial hubs with ports. The Bihar highway, spanning 83 km, is expected to cut travel time between Muzaffarpur and Sonbarsa from two hours to one hour. **SEE P9**

Spurious liquor claims 4 lives in Gujarat

BHAVNAGAR: Four people have died and 18 others are undergoing treatment, including eight in critical condition, after consuming suspected spurious liquor in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district, officials said on Wednesday. Four alleged bootleggers have been detained as police investigate the supply of duplicate bottles carrying the label of a popular Indian-Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) brand. Bhavnagar Collector Manish Kumar said the administration received information around 6 pm on Tuesday after five friends fell ill following a gathering in Kharkadi village in Ghogha taluka. **CONTINUED ON P4**

DEFENCE STANDS READY



India's players defend goal during the World Cup Field Hockey pool D match against Pakistan in Amstelveen, Netherlands, on Wednesday **FULL REPORT ON P10**

NCERT reconstitutes political science textbook team, four have RSS links

MPPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 19

The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) has reconstituted its textbook development team for Classes 11 and 12 political science, assigning it the task of incorporating cultural rootedness, Indian knowledge systems and inclusion into the new books.

The team has been asked to complete the Class 11 textbook by November this year and the Class 12 textbook by July next year. It will be headed by academic and political analyst Sandeep Shastri, vice president of Karnataka-based Nitte deemed university.

At least four members of the 24-member team have documented direct or indirect links

with the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS), its student organisation Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), or the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP).

Yadunath Deshpande, currently a senior consultant with the Ministry of Education, has held organisational positions in the ABVP. The organisation's records identify him as its **CONTINUED ON P4**

Institutionalise NTA reforms, SC tells Centre, seeks action report in 3 weeks

MPPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 19

The Supreme Court on Wednesday directed the Centre to inform it about steps taken to implement recommendations of the Radhakrishnan Committee and the Nandan Nilekani-led task force for reforms in the National Testing Agency (NTA), saying the changes must be institutionalised.

A bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe said the NTA needed better infrastructure, manpower and technological capabilities to conduct entrance examinations smoothly. It also called for greater use of technology to strengthen the examination system.

"We direct the Secretary to file an affidavit indicating and detailing the steps that have been taken to implement the suggestions made by the Radhakrishnan committee as reflected and nuanced by the Nandan Nilekani committee," the bench said, directing that the affidavit, along **CONTINUED ON P4**

Kolkata hotel fire claims 9 lives

GOURAB NETO
Kolkata, August 19

Within days of nine pilgrims being killed in the Tarapith hotel fire, tragedy struck again in Bengal – this time in the heart of Kolkata. A pre-dawn blaze turned a budget hotel on

Mirza Ghalib Street, in the New Market area, into a death trap on Wednesday, killing nine people, including a three-year-old child and two women. Five of the victims were Bangladeshi nationals, most in the city for medical treatment or tourism, while at least 80

people were rescued.

The Bangladesh Deputy High Commission said local police had identified five Bangladeshi nationals among the nine dead. It said four belonged to the same family and that it had contacted their families. Six injured **CONTINUED ON P4**

TAKE 1-0 LEAD IN THE TWO-TEST SERIES

Victory in 600th Test revives India's WTC hopes

MPPOST BUREAU
Galle, August 19

India renewed their hopes of winning the World Test Championship with a 165-run victory over Sri Lanka in the opening Test at Galle on Wednesday, completing the result just minutes before heavy rain swept across the International Stadium. Manav Suthar finished with 6/55 in the second innings and a match haul of 10 wickets as Sri Lanka were dismissed for 206 after starting the final day on 84/4 and needing another 288 runs.



The victory gave India a 1-0 lead in the two-Test series and came in their 600th Test match.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Manav Suthar took 10 wickets
- » Sri Lanka were bowled out for 206 while chasing 372 runs
- » Suthar claimed four wickets in his final 10 balls of the innings
- » The victory came in India's 600th Test match
- » The second Test begins in Colombo on August 23

The result also ended a tense final day in which weather threatened to deny India the chance to

finish the job. Rain had been forecast at the start of play, and a draw would have damaged India's position in the World Test Championship, where they entered the match fifth in the standings. However, the weather remained clear long enough for India to take the remaining six wickets. Within five minutes of Suthar taking the final wicket, the rain arrived.

Sri Lanka's overnight batters, captain Dhananjaya de Silva and Sonal Dinusha, **CONTINUED ON P4**

VIT
Vellore Institute of Technology
(Chartered by the University under section 3 of UOC Act, 1996)

41st Annual Convocation
8
Inauguration of
Centre for Advanced Research
in
Bacteriophage and Infectious Diseases (CARBID)
(Sponsored by ICMR, Govt. of India, New Delhi & VIT)
22nd AUGUST 2026 - SATURDAY | Time : 9.30 A.M.

CHIEF GUEST

Smt. Rekha Gupta
Hon'ble Chief Minister, Delhi

GUEST OF HONOUR
Mr. Babu Unnikrishnan
Vice President & CTO - BFSI, Tata Consultancy Services

PRESIDED BY
Dr. G. Viswanathan
Founder & Chancellor

www.vit.ac.in

TIKRI KALAN CNG BLAST

Fuel pump worker lay bleeding for over 30 mins, alleges family

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

Families of workers caught in a CNG station blast in Delhi on Wednesday said they struggled to get their loved ones to hospital, with one family claiming a critically injured worker lay bleeding for nearly half an hour before being taken away.

Family members of 25-year-old Manish found him bleeding at the fuel pump where the blast occurred.

“He lay there for half an hour. He had lost so much blood. How could anyone survive?” his uncle Vijay Prasad stated.

Manish had been working at the station for around three years and had reported for his shift at about 2 pm. The blast occurred later in the afternoon while CNG was being refilled in a truck.

Prasad said the family received a call informing them that Manish was seriously injured.

“I got a call saying that a cylinder had exploded and Manish was serious. I called my brother, and he, my nephew and several other people came here,” he said.

“There was no one to take him. All gas station staff ran away,” Prasad said. Manish was eventually taken to Safdarjung Hospital, but had lost a significant amount of blood by then, his uncle said.



People gather at a CNG station where the cylinder of a truck exploded while it was being refilled, at Tikri Kalan area, in New Delhi, on Wednesday

BLOODSHED AFTERMATH

- » Manish was eventually taken to Safdarjung Hospital, but had lost a significant amount of blood by then, his uncle said
- » ‘There was no one to take him. All gas station staff ran away’
- » Manish was among three workers killed in the blast. The other two victims were identified as Brahmjeet and Sunny both residents of Nizampur and employees at the station
- » Aditya, a relative of Brahmjeet and Akshay, an injured worker, said the two brothers had been working at the CNG station for around two years. Brahmjeet died on the spot

Manish was among three workers killed in the blast, police said. The other two victims were identified as Brahmjeet, 34, and Sunny, 30, both residents of Nizampur and employees at the station.

Aditya, a relative of Brahmjeet and Akshay, an injured worker, said the two brothers had been working at the CNG station for around two years. Brahmjeet died on the spot.

“Akshay has severe injuries on his back and internal and blunt trauma. He is in critical condition. Brahmjeet passed away on the spot,” Aditya said.

Both men were married and had two children each, he said. The family, which is from Nizampur, rushed to the spot after learning about the blast.

“When we arrived, there was no police or ambulance. We had to carry them to Jeevan Jyoti Hospital in Bahadurgarh ourselves,” he alleged.

Senior police officers reached the spot after the blast. Six people were hospitalised, while the explosion’s exact cause remained unknown.

Cops: Rocket launchers linked to suspected terrorists destroyed in controlled operation

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

A joint operation by the Army, Special Cell of the Delhi Police and Forensic Science Laboratory (FSL) is underway in Delhi’s Narela, where rocket launchers recovered in connection with two suspected terrorists arrested in Manipur are being destroyed, sources said on Wednesday.

The recovered weapons, which were brought to Delhi for examination and disposal, were part of a cache of arms, ammunition and explosive material seized during a joint search operation in Manipur in connection with the case, sources said.

The recovery included rifles, hundreds of rounds of live ammunition, detonators and other explosive material, they said.

The exercise is being carried out by specialised



“RECOVERED WEAPONS, WHICH WERE BROUGHT TO DELHI FOR EXAMINATION AND DISPOSAL, WERE PART OF A CACHE OF ARMS, AMMUNITION...”

teams and the recovered weapons are being disposed of in a controlled manner as part of the operation, they said.

Security arrangements have been put in place around the area, sources said.

National-level wrestler nabbed in drug smuggling case after 3 years

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

A national-level wrestler named in a drug smuggling case in Jharkhand in 2023 has been arrested by Delhi Police after a three-year-long manhunt, an official said on Wednesday.

Amit Sheoran (31), a resident of Rohtak district in Haryana, was arrested near Madhuban Chowk Metro Station in north-west Delhi on Tuesday night, he said.

Sheoran was wanted in an NDPS case registered at Dhurwa (Tupudana) police station in Ranchi after 492 grams of opium was allegedly recovered from a drug supplier in April 2023.

According to the police, the supplier, Rajesh Nag, during interrogation disclosed that he cultivated opium and supplied it specifically to wrestlers in north India. He allegedly named Sheoran and another accused, Ranjeet, as receivers of the drug.

Pak national detained

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

A Pakistani national was detained by the Delhi Police from Old Delhi for allegedly staying illegally in the national capital, police sources said.

According to the sources, the man had entered India through Nepal and was working at a restaurant in Delhi. He was detained on August 15 during an investigation into his alleged illegal stay in the country.

“The man’s mother was originally from Delhi but had married a Pakistani national and subsequently acquired Pakistani citizenship,” the source said.

The accused was questioned at length by the Delhi Police and central

ENTERED INDIA THROUGH NEPAL, HE WAS WORKING AT A RESTAURANT WHEN DETAINED ON AUG 15 OVER ILLEGAL STAY

agencies to ascertain his background and activities, he added.

No terror angle has emerged during the questioning so far. After questioning, the man was handed over to the Foreigners Regional Registration Office (FRRO), where the process for his deportation to Pakistan has been initiated, the source added.

The agencies are also verifying details related to his entry into India.

Fugitive arrested after 2-km chase

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Delhi Police Crime Branch arrested Wamiq, 29, a key accused in the abduction of scrap businessman Nizamuddin for a Rs 2 crore ransom on January 2. Police said Wamiq and four others abducted him near Okhla Metro Station. Nizamuddin escaped at a petrol pump. Wamiq remained absconding until his arrest in New Ashok Nagar following a two-kilometre chase.

DU steps up security for peaceful DUSU polls

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Delhi University administration has stepped up security measures ahead of the Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) elections, deploying more than 500 CCTV cameras to monitor key routes across the North and South campuses, a senior official said on Wednesday.

Delhi University Proctor Manoj Kumar Singh said the administration was strictly implementing the recommendations of the Lyngdoh Committee and warned candidates and student groups that violations could lead to cancellation of nominations and, in serious cases, even the election.

Blind candidate Pankaj Dhingra campaigns for DUSU

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

A blind law student at Delhi University’s Campus Law Centre is seeking to contest the upcoming Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) elections, bringing the representation of students with disabilities into focus.

Pankaj Dhingra, a prospective candidate campaigning with the Aam Aadmi Party’s student wing, Association of Students for Alternative Politics (ASAP), is

seeking to contest the elections scheduled for September 18. His campaign focuses on greater participation and representation of students with disabilities, who, according to ASAP, continue to face barriers to accessing opportunities and participating fully in campus life.

ASAP said Dhingra’s candidature seeks to broaden student politics and give greater space to underrepresented voices. It said students with disabilities should not only benefit from policies but also participate in student politics.

related law and order arrangements.

“We will strictly follow the Lyngdoh Committee,” Singh said during an interaction on election-

related law and order arrangements.

The university has been coordinating with Delhi Police to monitor vehicles on campus routes, and efforts over the past month

have helped curb clustering of vehicles, he said.

The administration has also banned printed pamphlets and posters for election campaigning. Candidates have been asked to

use handwritten posters only at designated “Wall of Democracy” spaces.

Singh said there had been no reports of wall defacement or spray painting so far, with university and police teams conducting regular rounds across the campuses. The proctor has also urged principals of all 54 colleges to set up two “Walls of Democracy”, each measuring 10x10 feet -- one for DUSU election campaigning and the other for college-level committees.

DU limits campaigners, monitors vehicles and social media, and deploys police to prevent violations and ensure peaceful DUSU elections.

Gang shooters held

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 19

Two sharpshooters allegedly linked to the Kapil Sangwan alias Nandu and Bambiha gang have been arrested by the Delhi Police Crime Branch in connection with firing incidents in Delhi and Punjab, allegedly carried out on the orders of Canada-based gangster Devinder Singh alias Gopi Lahoria.

The accused were identified as Harshdeep Singh alias Billa, 22, of Nangal village in Ludhiana, Punjab, and Harmanjit Singh, 23, of Tangra village in Amritsar, Punjab. Police arrested them following a tip-off.

The duo were wanted in connection with two firing incidents -- at the residence of Umed Singh in Deenpur, Najafgarh, on August 16 and at a pizza joint in Ludhiana on August 17.

According to police, the accused arrived in Delhi on August 14 and stayed in Dwarka Mor. They were allegedly instructed to kill a person and purchased two semi-automatic pistols and 19 rounds of ammunition from East Delhi on August 15.

They fled the target’s home after seeing women and children, later fired at a Ludhiana pizza joint, and were arrested after returning to Delhi.

568 lost, stolen mobile phones recovered: Cops

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Delhi Police recovered 568 lost or stolen mobile phones using the Central Equipment Identity Register (CEIR) portal and returned them to their owners, an officer said on Wednesday.

The recovery drive was conducted from July 1 to August 15. The oldest phone recovered had been stolen in December 2021, while latest was reported stolen in May this year. CEIR lets users block stolen phones using IMEI numbers, helping police trace them when reconnected.

Japan investment boost for UP

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, August 19

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath on Wednesday urged Japanese companies to make the state their “second industrial home”, as the government announced investments worth Rs 3,191 crore in the Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority (YEIDA) area.

Addressing the Uttar Pradesh-Japan Investment Meet 2026 in New Delhi, Yogi said Japanese firms should go beyond manufacturing and establish technology centres, research and development facilities, skill development institutions and global supply chains in the state.

The event, attended by more than 200 Japanese business leaders led by Yamanashi Governor Kotaro Nagasaki, featured



the virtual groundbreaking of two major projects in YEIDA. Escorts Kubota Ltd will establish a manufacturing facility in Sector 10 on around 154 acres, investing approximately Rs 2,025-2,029 crore and creating around 4,000 jobs. The plant will manufacture about 60,000 tractors annually, besides construction equipment and agricultural machinery.

Spark Minda Group will invest around Rs 1,166 crore in manufacturing projects in Sectors 10 and 24, expected to generate about 6,440 jobs. The facilities will produce

advanced automotive components, including electronic switches, sensors, USB chargers and wiring systems. Yogi also announced a proposed Japanese City over around 500 acres in Sector 5A, offering integrated industrial, commercial and residential infrastructure for Japanese companies and their employees.

He highlighted UP’s expressways, airports and industrial corridors, identifying electronics, semiconductors, green hydrogen, solar energy, medical devices and advanced manufacturing as key areas.

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, August 19

Anger over damaged roads, potholes, waterlogging and incomplete civic work continues to simmer in Burari, where residents have taken to the streets demanding a time-bound solution to problems they say have persisted for years.

AAP MLA from Burari Sanjeev Jha, however, said the situation must be viewed in the context of a large infrastructure project being executed in phases. He said the road stretch is around 9 km long, with the project originally given an overall timeline of about 26 months. Work began in July 2023.

According to Jha, the first phase, covering around 4 km, was completed by October 2024, with the road ready by November. The second phase, cover-



ing the remaining 5 km, began in March 2025 and was expected to take about 14 months. However, the project subsequently faced delays following the change of government and a delay in tender sanction.

Jha said the tender has been pending since February 2026 and the work is still being finalised.

RESIDENTS SEEK ACTION BEYOND ASSURANCES

Burari potholes, waterlogging persist

PHASED PROJECT

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He blamed the worsening condition of the road on delays and alleged negligence by the PWD, saying the work should have progressed faster.

The MLA also acknowledged residents’ concerns, saying he travels on the same road every day and faces the problems himself. He said the current situa-

tion was a matter of concern and expressed hope that the pending work would be completed and residents would get relief within the next 2-3 months.

Residents, meanwhile, continue to demand that authorities move beyond assurances and provide a clear timeline for restoring the roads and drainage system.

SIR revised: Final voter list November 4

Draft electoral roll on August 31

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The schedule of the Special Intensive Revision exercise in Delhi was revised on Wednesday by the Election Commission, fixing November 4 for the publication of the final voter list, with officials saying the extension was needed for the rationalisation of polling stations. According to the earlier schedule, the final electoral roll was to be published on October 27. This is the third revision of the SIR schedule in Delhi since the exercise was launched with door-to-door distribution of enumeration forms among voters from June 30. Poll officials said that the latest revision was made on technical grounds including rationalisation of polling stations in the city. Under the revised schedule, the draft electoral rolls will be published on August 31 instead of August 24, said a statement from the office of Delhi CEO citing an EC letter. The period of filing claims and objections by the voters whose names are excluded from the draft rolls has also been changed. Earlier, the filing of claims and objections was to be done from August 24 to September 23. Now, the voters can file their claims and objections from August 31 to September 30. The poll officials will dispose of the claims and

UPDATE

- » According to the earlier schedule, the final electoral roll was to be published on October 27
- » Under the revised schedule, the draft electoral rolls will be published on August 31 instead of August 24
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objections from August 31 to October 29. Previously, the phase was scheduled from 24 August to October 22. The extension in SIR dates has been necessitated by the rationalisation of polling stations, with the Election Commission mandating that each polling station should have a maximum of 1,200 electors, the poll officials said. The SIR of electoral rolls is being carried out on the basis of Delhi's pre-SIR voter database. There were 1.45 crore electors when the electoral rolls were frozen on June 16.

Delhi plugs in 200 e-buses, fleet crosses 5,000

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 19

Delhi on Wednesday expanded its green public transport network with the induction of 200 new electric buses, taking the city's electric bus fleet beyond the 5,000-mark. Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta flagged off the buses at the Delhi University Sports Complex while also launching the Delhi-Karnal interstate e-bus service, 56 Ladies Special bus services and a public



EV charging station at DTC's Rajghat Depot-I. The newly inducted fleet comprises 88 12-metre and 112 nine-metre DEVI electric

buses, taking Delhi's total bus fleet to around 6,800. The government aims to expand the fleet to nearly 14,000 buses by 2028-29. Five air-conditioned electric buses will operate on the Delhi-Karnal route, making 10 trips daily in each direction. The buses will connect Kashmere Gate with Karnal via Singhu Border, Rai, Bahalgarh, Murthal, Gannaur, Samalkha, Panipat, Gharaunda and Madhuban. To enhance women's safety, the government also launched 56 dedicated women-only e-bus services, including 30 Ladies Special and 26 University Ladies Special trips. The buses will operate during peak hours with women staff, women

police personnel and Home Guards on board. Panic buttons on the buses have also been integrated with Delhi Police's 112 emergency response system. A public EV charging station with four 240-kW chargers capable of charging buses, commercial EVs and electric cars was also inaugurated at Rajghat Depot-I. Addressing the event, Sandhu said, "Promoting connectivity and green mobility in Delhi in line with the vision of 'Gati Shakti' is an important step towards building a 'Viksit Delhi'." Chief Minister

Rekha Gupta said, "The expansion of electric buses, interstate e-bus connectivity, dedicated bus services for women and public EV charging infrastructure are all steps towards building a Delhi where public transport is clean, smart and becomes the first choice for every citizen." Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said, "Concrete steps and better operations have helped DTC turn profitable this year," adding that the transport corporation's fleet would continue expanding over the next three years.

Janakpuri gets 1st Atal Canteen



OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

Delhi Urban Development Minister Ashish Sood on Wednesday inaugurated the first Atal Canteen in Janakpuri, saying the initiative is aimed at ensuring that affordable and nutritious meals are available to economically weaker sections for just Rs 5.

Located in JJ Colony opposite Mother Dairy on Old Pankha Road, the canteen is the latest addition to the Delhi government's expanding network of subsidised community kitchens under its Antyodaya initiative. Speaking at the inauguration, Sood said the government's objective was to ensure that no one in the capital goes hungry because of financial hardship. "With this new initiative of the Delhi Government aimed at public service and welfare, no poor person in Delhi will have to go to bed hungry," he said. The minister said the meals served at Atal Canteens are balanced, hygienic and nutritious, while also benefiting daily wage workers and others who are unable to cook fresh meals during the day. Sood noted that the government had opened 25 new Atal Canteens across Delhi on Sunday and plans to further expand the network in the coming months. He said the initiative complements the government's efforts to improve living conditions in JJ colonies and other economically weaker settlements by combining food security with ongoing housing initiatives for vulnerable families.

Delhi govt promotes over 100 DASS officers

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Delhi government on Wednesday promoted 111 officers of the Delhi Administration Subordinate Service (DASS) Grade-I cadre and issued orders for their fresh postings across key departments in a move aimed at improving governance and speeding up public service delivery. According to the Services Department, the officers have been assigned responsibilities in the education, health, revenue, trade and taxes, law and vigilance departments, as well as the Lieutenant

Governor's Secretariat. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the promotions would strengthen the government's administrative machinery and improve delivery of citizen-centric services. "Making the administrative system efficient and accountable is our government's priority," she said, adding that the decision would accelerate work in departments such as health, education and revenue. A significant number of promoted officers have been posted as Deputy Directors in the Education Department.

MPD-2047 plans utility infra for future growth

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 19

The Master Plan of Delhi for 2047 (MPD-247) has proposed detailed land norms for essential civic infrastructure, including sewage and water treatment plants, waste-management facilities and electricity substations, with the aim of ensuring that utility infrastructure is planned alongside the city's future expansion. However, experts say planning land must be matched by timely execution.

Dedicated space for water, sewage facilities
Under the proposed norms, sewage treatment

plants (STPs) with sewage and effluent pumping stations of up to 5 MGD (22.7 MLD) capacity will require 650 sqm per MLD, while larger STPs will require 1,100 sqm per MLD. Sewage and effluent pumping stations will require 50 sqm per MLD. For water treatment plants, the plan proposes 300 sqm per MLD for an 80 MGD (363 MLD) facility and 400 sqm per MLD for a 40 MGD (182 MLD) facility. Underground reservoirs with booster pumping stations will also have specified land requirements. The proposed framework comes as Delhi continues to expand its sewage-treatment network. The city's STP capacity is

around 814 MGD, with the government targeting 1,506 MGD per day. At the same time, monitoring has shown that some existing plants require improvement in operations and compliance. A senior planning official said, "The objective is to ensure that adequate land is identified for essential infrastructure at the planning stage itself, rather than trying to accommodate these facilities after development has taken place." **Waste infrastructure gets planning focus**
For solid waste management, the plan proposes 200 sqm per 10,000 population for local-level waste segregation and utility-vehicle

parking facilities. At the sub-city level, material recovery facilities would require 6,000-8,000 sqm per five lakh population. The provision assumes significance as Delhi's waste generation is expected to rise substantially over the coming decades. The norms are aimed at creating a planned network for segregation, recovery and processing closer to areas where waste is generated. But Delhi currently generates around 11,862 tonnes of municipal solid waste a day against processing capacity of 7,641 TPD, leaving a gap of about 4,200 tonnes daily. MCD's waste segregation rate was also only around 59%, according

to the 2025-26 Economic Survey, highlighting the importance of ensuring that earmarked land is eventually backed by functional facilities and effective waste segregation. **Power infrastructure also mapped**
MPD-2047 proposes land requirements ranging from 48-80 sqm for 11-kV substations to 16 hectares for 765-kV substations, providing a long-term framework for electricity infrastructure as demand rises. Experts said the approach could help Delhi avoid the problem of finding utility land after residential and commercial development has already taken place.

Master Plan gives parking a 5% boost

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 19

The proposed Master Plan for Delhi-2047 seeks to ease chronic parking shortages in the city's shop-cum-residence markets by allowing an additional 5 per cent ground coverage within scheme areas for the development of public parking facilities. The provision forms part of the draft regulations for shop plots and shop-cum-residence plots, later designated as Community Centres (CC), Local Shopping Centres (LSC) and Convenience Shopping Centres (CSC). Besides permitting commercial activities allowed in Local Shopping Centres, the draft also makes parking a key requirement for redevelopment. Under the proposal, parking must be provided either within individual premises or through shared/common parking developed across the scheme area. To facilitate this, the Master Plan, allows 5 per cent additional ground coverage exclusively for creating public parking infrastructure. The draft further states that if adequate parking cannot be provided in the vicinity, local bodies may declare such markets as pedestrian shopping streets or areas, while public transport agencies will be required to ensure last-mile connectivity. To address congestion, the plan also places responsibility on traders' associations. In consultation with local bodies, they will have to prepare Improvement Plans covering traffic and parking management, fire safety, civic amenities, financing and implementation. These plans will require approval from the concerned local authority.

4 MCD councillors eye DDA Advisory Council



ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 19

Four councillors of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) filed their nominations on Wednesday for membership of the Delhi Development Authority's (DDA) Advisory Council, with the election scheduled to be held at the civic body's meeting on August 24. The nominations were filed at the Municipal Secretary's office in the Civic Centre on the last day of the nomination process. The BJP has nominated Neema Bhagat, councillor from Ward 210 (Geeta Colony), and Jyoti Agarwal, representing Ward 60 (Rani Bagh). The Aam Aadmi

Party has fielded Shivani Panchal from Ward 223 (Rohtash Nagar) and Chitra Vidyarthi from Ward 66 (Wazirpur). Mayor Pravesh Wahi, Deputy Mayor Monika Pant and Leader of House Jai Bhagwan Yadav were present during the filing of nominations. The four councillors will now contest the election to represent the MCD on the DDA's Advisory Council. The outcome could assume significance as Delhi's urban planning framework undergoes a major review. Wahi congratulated the councillors and expressed hope that the elected representatives would contribute constructively to the DDA's deliberations.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 19

Sanitation workers in east Delhi on Wednesday called off their strike over the killing of a 27-year-old colleague, resuming work even as the victim's family continues to raise questions over his post-mortem and cremation. The workers had been protesting since Sunday, demanding Rs 1 crore compensation and a government job for the kin of MCD sanitation worker Anil Kumar, who was stabbed to death. The agitation that lasted three days disrupted garbage collection in parts of east and northeast Delhi, with heaps of waste banked up at several locations. The strike was called off a day after the police detained AAP MLA Kuldeep Kumar. Karan Singh Mahroliya, a member of the sanitation workers' union, "We called off the strike yesterday after the MLA was detained. From



today, all services, including the operation of auto-tippers, have resumed." He said the workers will continue to raise their demands in the future. Kumar visited Anil's family in Ghaziabad on Wednesday. The MLA alleged that the Delhi government gave no compensation to the family and reiterated the demand for Rs 1 crore and a government job for Anil's brother.

He also demanded financial assistance for Anil's sister's marriage, and alleged that the family's consent was not obtained before the post-mortem. Kumar said he would pursue legal action against the police over the manner in which the body was handled. Anil's father also alleged that the family was not consulted before the post-mortem and was pressured for cremation. He alleged that police came to the family's home around midnight, took him away, and forced him to sign some documents. "They forcibly took us and made us sign. I kept asking why I should sign," Anil's father said. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi said the strike ended following a meeting between Standing Committee chairperson Satya Sharma, representatives of a private waste-collector company and sanitation workers.

Around 95% power bills paid digitally in Capital

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

Digital payments of electricity bills have surged to 95 per cent in Delhi, with the city distribution companies (dicoms) coming up with self-service options for their consumers. Delhi's power discoms, BSES Rajdhani Power Limited (BRPL), BSES Yamuna Power Limited and Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL), stated that around 95 per cent of their consumers are making digital payments for bills. Digital payments by consumers of BSES discoms, supplying electricity in Delhi, except for North and North West areas which fall under TPDDL jurisdiction, surged from 85 per cent to nearly 95 per cent. Also, around 85 per cent of BSES customer service requests are now raised digitally, said a company statement. A Tata Power Delhi Distribution Limited (TPDDL) spokesperson in a statement said that digital pay-

ments and self-service adoption have scaled up with 95 per cent of its 22 lakh consumers making bill payments through digital modes. Digital payment transactions increased from 74.3 lakh in 2021-22 (83.4 per cent) to 1.1 crore (93 per cent) in 2025-26, said TPDDL statement. Also, the non-digital transactions declined by over 43 per cent, from 14.81 lakh to 8.46 lakh during the five-year period, reflecting consumers' growing preference for secure, seamless and contactless payment options, it said. BSES consumers are moving from counters to self-service digital platforms, said the company spokesperson. The increase has been steady over the last four years. The share of digital payment transactions rose from 85 per cent in 2021-22 to 87 per cent in 2022-23, 89 per cent in 2023-24, 92 per cent in 2024-25 and 93 per cent in 2025-26, before moving closer to the 95 per cent mark currently, he said.

BALASORE ON HIGH ALERT AS SUBARNAREKHA WATER LEVEL RISING

Odisha flood situation remain grim

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi 18 March

The flood situation in six districts of Odisha remained grim on Wednesday with over 11.80 lakh people being affected, while the state government put the Balasore district on high alert due to an alarming rise in the water level of the Subarnarekha river.

Odisha's Revenue and Disaster Management minister Suresh Pujari said that though the water level in most of the rivers was static or receding by Wednesday afternoon, it was alarmingly rising in the Subarnarekha.

"The district administrations of Bhadrak, Jajpur and Mayurbhanj are told to be cautious, but the Balasore district collector has been specifically put on high alert and asked to take required measures. The flood in Subarnarekha could impact densely pop-



An aerial view of agricultural fields and residential areas inundated by the overflowing waters of the Jalaka River following heavy rains, in Baleswar district, Odisha

KEY POINTS

- » Other rivers in the district like Budhabalanga and Jalaka are more or less stable, but many villages have already remained marooned and road connections were cut off
- » 'Over 4 lakh people have been evacuated to safety, and the process is continuing in Balasore district where the Subarnarekha is creating havoc'

ulated Baliapal, Basta, the minister told reporters. Jaleswar and Basta blocks," A report from Balasore

said that the water level of the river stood at 11.22 metres against the danger level of 10.36 metres at 5 pm on Wednesday, and it is expected to rise further as water release from Galudih and Chandili dams in Jharkhand continues.

"Thousands of people living in low-lying and riverbank areas in Bhograi, Jaleswar, Basta and Baliapal blocks have already been impacted. The administration has deployed rescue teams and asked people of these areas to be alert," an official said.

Other rivers in the district like Budhabalanga and Jalaka are more or less stable, but many villages have already remained marooned and road connections were cut off.

The minister said, "Tonight is crucial for Balasore as the peak flood is expected to pass through the Subarnarekha river around midnight. The field-

level officials are already at the ground level with rescue and relief teams."

Pujari, however, said that there is a respite for other districts due to very low rain in the last 24 hours.

He said that the second spell of flood so far has affected over 11.80 lakh people spread over 1579 villages under 68 blocks.

Over 4 lakh people have been evacuated to safety, and the process is continuing in Balasore district where the Subarnarekha is creating havoc, he said.

Asked about the human casualty, the minister said that no such report is confirmed so far, but four live-stock deaths were reported from Balasore.

The flood situation in neighbouring Bhadrak and Jajpur districts was no different, with the Salandi river flowing at 17.10 metres against the danger mark of 17 metres at Rajghat.

Victory in 600th Test revives India's WTC hopes

Continued from Page 1

Initially frustrated India. The pair added 95 runs from 202 balls and remained together for more than an hour in the morning session. De Silva scored 59 from 151 balls, while Dinusha, who had made 100 in the first innings, reached 84 in the second.

Ravindra Jadeja eventually provided the breakthrough. After discussing his approach with head coach Gautam Gambhir, Jadeja changed his angle and continued attacking the stumps. De Silva attempted a sweep but top-edged the shot, with Suthar taking the catch at short fine leg. The dismissal ended the 95-run stand and opened the door for India.

Niroshan Dickwella, who had scored 80 in Sri Lanka's first innings, could not stay for long. Looking to attack, he tried to manufacture a shot against Prasadh Krishna and edged the ball to wicketkeeper Rishabh Pant. Sri Lanka were 199/7 at that stage, but the next phase of

the innings belonged almost entirely to Suthar.

Returning after the break, the left-arm spinner removed Dinusha, Prabath Jayasuriya and Lahiru Kumara within six deliveries. Dinusha's dismissal came after he had battled for 128 balls. Suthar's delivery pitched on leg stump and produced an inside edge that was taken by Dhruv Jurel at leg slip. Dinusha finished the match with 184 runs across the two innings.

Jayasuriya was bowled after playing down the wrong line, while Kumara edged behind and chose not to review. Suthar then dismissed Keshara Nuwantha to complete the innings and secure his second consecutive five-wicket haul in Tests. He had taken four wickets in Sri Lanka's first innings and finished with 10 wickets in the match.

India's victory had been set up by their batting in the first innings. Devdutt Padikkal, drafted into the team after Sai Sudharsan's injury,

scored 167 and shared a 162-run partnership with KL Rahul. His innings helped India build a strong total on a turning pitch and earned him the Player of the Match award.

Mohammed Siraj also played a key role in establishing India's control. During Sri Lanka's first innings, he bowled three maidens in nine overs and dismissed opener Nishan Madushka for a duck. Sri Lanka were eventually bowled out for 284, with only Dinusha's 100 and Dickwella's 80 providing substantial resistance.

India then declared their second innings at 193, with Pant making 66 from 69 balls, leaving Sri Lanka a target of 372. Four wickets fell before the close on the fourth day, and although Dinusha and de Silva delayed the finish, India completed the win on Wednesday.

The second Test will begin at the Sinhalese Sports Club in Colombo on August 23.

From page 1

Gor: J&K

He said the US puts out travel warnings and "every so often we re-evaluate those travel warnings. I cannot make any big announcements here today, but it is something we are going to look at."

"We will be looking at whether the travel warning that is imposed, which is recommended by the United States, is something that should be downgraded... have made some incredible steps to keeping this area safer and making it more safe," he said.

"I think a lot of Americans would enjoy coming here and seeing the beauty and opportunity that exists here," he further said.

Hours before Gor's visit, former chief minister and PDP chief Mehbooba Mufti appealed to him to review and withdraw America's strict travel advisory, highlighting how thousands of families in the Valley depend on tourism for livelihood.

Gor is on a two-day visit to Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh.

Abdullah said he discussed with Gor the relations between New Delhi and Washington with a specific focus on Jammu and Kashmir.

"It was a very good meeting. We had an opportunity to discuss the relations between our two countries, but with a specific focus on what the US can do with Jammu and Kashmir," the chief minister said.

"There are obviously certain legacy issues that over time we will be working to resolve. But we look forward to taking this conversation further. This is a conversation that will take place both between Ambassador Gor and Washington, and between me and the Government of India in New Delhi," he said.

Abdullah said he is very hopeful and optimistic that the engagement between the United States and Jammu and Kashmir will "both widen and deepen in the years ahead".

Meanwhile, Pakistan's Foreign Office rejected US Ambassador Sergio Gor's description of Jammu and Kashmir as part of India, calling the remarks "factually incorrect".

In a statement on Wednesday, Islamabad said its Foreign Secretary had summoned the US Chargé d'Affaires and lodged a "strong demarche" over Gor's comments.

Pakistan "strongly condemned and categorically rejected" the characterisation of Jammu and Kashmir

as "a part of India", describing the region as an "internationally recognised disputed territory".

It said the territory's final status must be determined in accordance with relevant United Nations Security Council resolutions and what it described as the aspirations of the Kashmiri people.

Islamabad also objected to the timing and nature of Gor's remarks, arguing that they were inconsistent with what Pakistan called Washington's longstanding position on the dispute.

"The irresponsible statement by the US Ambassador negated the long-standing and well-documented position of the United States on the J&K dispute," Pakistan said.

RBI Governor

policy tightening," Malhotra said, while calling for continued monitoring of food, fuel and other input costs.

The Governor also noted that the Indian economy had performed better than expected in the first quarter of 2026-27 despite external and weather-related challenges. The MPC said domestic demand, investment and exports continued to support economic activity, although geopolitical tensions, oil prices, the monsoon and the risk of El Niño remained sources of uncertainty.

Deputy Governor Poonam Gupta supported the wait-and-watch approach, saying more time was needed for weather conditions to settle, to assess whether supply-side inflation was becoming entrenched and to gain clarity on global developments.

RBI Executive Director and MPC member Indranil Bhattacharyya said limited pass-through from food and fuel price spikes indicated that inflation had not yet become broad-based. He said the expected normalisation of underlying inflation from earlier benign levels would require close monitoring of growth and inflation dynamics before any rate adjustment.

External member Nagesh Kumar cautioned against complacency despite a modest improvement in the growth and inflation outlook. He pointed to continuing risks from El Niño, the West Asia conflict, the Strait of Hormuz blockade and trade policy uncertainty. Ram Singh said growth of about 7 per cent, alongside core inflation remaining below 4 per cent for several quarters, suggested the economy was not showing signs of demand-driven overheating. He said incoming data would be crucial for monetary policy decisions.

The next MPC meeting is scheduled for October 5 to 7, 2026. The government has mandated the RBI to keep CPI inflation at 4 per cent, with a tolerance band of 2 per cent on either side. Under the RBI Act, 1934, the central bank publishes MPC minutes on the 14th day after each meeting.

CNG cylinder

The injured were identified as Surjeet, Sanjay and Vipin. They were taken to a hospital in Mundka for treatment. Police said one of the injured was in critical condition, while another account put their condition as serious but stable.

The Delhi Fire Service received a call at 3.37 pm and sent six fire tenders to the station. Police teams, including senior officers from the Outer district and Mundka police station, also reached the site and cordoned off the area.

The cause of the explosion has not yet been established. Police are examining the truck, CNG cylinder and refilling equipment to determine whether a technical fault, safety mechanism failure or another problem led to the blast. A forensic team and crime unit collected evidence from the site, while investigators are checking CCTV footage and statements of employees and others present there.

Police are also examining whether prescribed safety measures were being followed during refilling.

Vijay Prasad, an uncle of Manish, alleged a delay in getting medical help. "For nearly 30 minutes, he remained at the fuel pump ... before he could get an ambulance," he said, adding that Manish had lost a large amount of blood.

Kolkata hotel

Bangladeshi nationals were released after primary treatment. The mission said it was in continuous contact with hospitals and police and had set up a 24/7 helpline.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed condolences to the bereaved families and wished the injured a speedy recovery. The Prime Minister's Office said on X: "I am deeply heartbroken to hear the news of loss of life in the fire in Kolkata. My condolences to those who have lost their loved ones in this accident. May the injured recover swiftly. The local administration is assisting the affected."

Bengal Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari also expressed condolences and blamed the previous TMC government, alleging that infrastructure had been allowed to grow unchecked and basic compliance audits

were not enforced.

Kolkata Police registered a suo motu case under Sections 105, 125, 287 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, along with relevant provisions of the West Bengal Fire Services Act. A Special Investigation Team headed by Assistant Commissioner of the Detective Department Bhagirath Ghosh will probe the incident, under the supervision of Deputy Commissioner Sparsha Nilangi. The hotel manager has been detained, and the owner is absconding.

The fire broke out at Hotel Shikha Inn between 1.45 am and 2 am at 15G, Mirza Ghalib Street, popularly known as Free School Street – a stone's throw from the Fire and Emergency Services headquarters. Within minutes, thick black smoke engulfed the staircases and corridors, turning escape routes into deadly traps. While some guests managed to reach the rooftop, others remained trapped inside their rooms.

Five fire tenders, along with New Market police and the Disaster Management Group, rushed to the spot as panic gripped the area. Firefighters struggled to navigate the hotel's narrow passages, while the rear exit gate was allegedly found locked, further complicating the rescue operation.

Rescuers used ladders and broke through windows to reach guests trapped inside rooms and on the rooftop.

Nine unconscious people were taken to Calcutta Medical College and Hospital, where they were declared dead on arrival. Two victims were yet to be identified. They are suspected to have died of asphyxiation from smoke inhalation.

Preliminary investigation suggests the fire originated on the second floor, with officials suspecting an air-conditioner explosion.

Koushik Chowdhury, Minister of State, Fire and Emergency Services Department, said the hotel lacked basic firefighting equipment and proper emergency exits. Initial police reports also indicate that it was operating without a valid police licence.

"The most important part is that on every floor of this building, there are four to five hotels, and most of the rooms do not even have windows," he said.

A couple being rescued through a window illustrated how design features could determine who lived and who died, the minister said.

The tragedy has put the spotlight on how so many hotels could operate inside a single congested building, and whether they possessed mandatory fire clearances,

alarms, trade licences and other approvals.

Chowdhury said a forensic team had examined the premises and police had begun proceedings against the owner, who was absconding.

State Urban Development and Municipal Affairs minister Agnimitra Paul, who visited the site, alleged that 10 guest houses were operating in the building and questioned how they obtained permission, trade and fire licences and electricity connections. Targeting former minister and ex-Kolkata mayor Firhad Hakim, she said: "Firhad Hakim was the Mayor. He has to answer."

Paul said the government would scrutinise hotels and buildings and shut those found operating illegally. She also alleged that no fire audit had been conducted in the past 15 years.

She questioned how establishments operating in such cramped premises had obtained trade licences and the fire department's no-objection certificates.

Meanwhile, in the aftermath of the devastating fire, the KMC has ordered the affected hotel to remain closed indefinitely. The civic body has also decided to constitute separate inspection committees in all 16 boroughs to conduct a comprehensive review of safety arrangements at commercial establishments across the city.

NTA reforms

with indicative timelines, be filed within three weeks.

The seven-member Radhakrishnan Committee was constituted by the Ministry of Education after the NEET-UG paper leak controversy to suggest changes in the examination process, data security and the functioning of the NTA. The government later formed a high-powered task force headed by Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani to propose structural reforms in competitive examinations.

The court said reforms could not remain only on paper. "If you don't institutionalise, experienced people get transferred and the entire experience is lost," it observed, adding that the NTA must develop institutional expertise like the Union Public Service Commission (UPSC).

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told the court that several safeguards were in place for NEET examinations. Question banks are prepared by multiple moderators, while papers are printed separately under CCTV surveillance and CISF security. They are trans-

ported under police escort with GPS tracking and stored in bank strong rooms.

On examination day, one set is selected and taken to centres under security, where it is opened in the presence of officials and students. The process is videographed.

The bench noted that these safeguards had already been considered by the Radhakrishnan Committee.

The court was hearing petitions, including one filed by advocate Tanvi Dubey for the Federation of All India Medical Association, seeking restructuring or replacement of the NTA. The alleged 2024 NEET-UG paper leak is being investigated by the CBI.

NCERT reconstitutes

former joint state organising secretary for Maharashtra and later as an organising secretary in its Mumbai-Konkan structure. His LinkedIn profile also identifies him as a political consultant for the BJP.

Prashant Divekar has been associated with Pune-based Jnana Prabodhini, an RSS-affiliated institution founded in 1962 by Vinayak Vishwanath, an RSS member and pracharak. On the National Council for Teacher Education's National Mission for Mentoring portal, Divekar describes his approach as being "rooted in Bhartiya educational philosophy" and says he has contributed to the National Curriculum Framework.

Vandana Mishra, a professor at Jawaharlal Nehru University's Centre for Political Studies, is a former national secretary of the ABVP. Another JNU academic, Ravi Rameshchandra Shukla, is an associate professor at the Centre for Comparative Politics and Political Theory. He has served on the editorial board of the Indian Journal of Democratic Governance, published by the Indian Institute of Democratic Leadership-Rambhau Mhalgi Prabodhini, an RSS affiliate. Devendra Fadnavis became the institute's president in 2021.

Shukla has also researched cultural and spiritual nationalism and is principal investigator of an ICSSR-funded JNU project on the role of the Kumbha and Magh Mela in shaping the "Spiritual and Cultural Nationalism of Bharat".

Other members include academics and educators from JNU, National Law University, Chanakya University, Delhi University, IGNOU, National University of Study and Research in Law, Jindal Global Law School, Pondicherry University and Utkal University. NCERT officials

Savita Sagar, Vanthangpui Khobung and Subhash Singh are also part of the team, with Khobung serving as member coordinator and Singh as co-coordinator.

According to the NCERT notification issued by Director Dinesh Prasad Saklani, the team will work with curricular area groups covering social science, languages, Indian knowledge systems, environmental education, innovative pedagogy and teaching-learning material. It will also consult other groups to establish links across grades, strengthen interdisciplinarity and incorporate multilingual perspectives.

The notification said each textbook would undergo review for the integration of cross-cutting themes, including cultural rootedness, Indian knowledge systems, inclusion, educational technology and assessment.

Spurious liquor

People from other villages and parts of Bhavnagar city were later found to be affected, taking the total number of people impacted to 22.

The deceased were identified as Kartik Makwana, 40, Upendra Gohil, 25, Ghanashyam Jadedja, 50, and Narendrar Yadav. Kumar said it was yet to be conclusively established whether Yadav's death was linked to the liquor.

Of the 18 people being treated, two are in critical condition, four are in intensive care and two are on ventilators, while 10 are stable. One affected person from Surat is receiving treatment there, while another from Jamnagar is asymptomatic.

Kumar urged anyone who had consumed IMFL of the particular brand in the past four days to undergo a medical examination, even if they had no symptoms. Doctors from Sir T Hospital and Ahmedabad's Institute of Kidney Diseases and Research Centre (IKDRC) are being sent to treatment camps at private hospitals to assist medical teams.

Superintendent of Police Nitesh Pandey said the affected people had consumed liquor from duplicate bottles. Police teams using technical surveillance and local intelligence detained four bootleggers linked to the supply chain in Vartej and other areas.

Preliminary investigation suggests the bottles were supplied from Madhya Pradesh. Police are examining their source, production and distribution network. Several bottles have been seized, while efforts are underway to locate others involved. An FSL team is also assisting the investigation. Gujarat is a dry state, where the manufacture, sale and consumption of alcohol are prohibited.

MPOST

Briefs

Nadda discharged from AIIMS

NEW DELHI: Union Health Minister JP Nadda, who underwent angioplasty at AIIMS Delhi, was discharged from the hospital on Wednesday, hospital authorities said. "Nadda was discharged today after undergoing angioplasty. He had a comfortable stay in hospital and thanked all doctors, nurses and staff for the care provided," AIIMS said. Nadda underwent the procedure on August 17 and was kept under observation.

CM Vijay warns DMK

CHENNAI: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Wednesday warned opposition DMK against persistently demanding evidence of past regime corruption, stating he already possesses "incriminating files" from three government departments on his table. The "incriminating files" have already been reviewed and currently kept on his table, he said, warning that he would reveal the details soon.

PK calls on Tejashwi

PATNA: Jan Suraj founder Prashant Kishor on Wednesday said Tejashwi Yadav's Lok Bhawan march over last month's police action against NEET paper leak protesters was befitting his role as the leader of the opposition, and he "should be done more often". Reacting to the events, he said: "Yadav is the LoP, and it is his job to protest against government policies. He does it occasionally, but he should do it more often."

BRICS tourism meet held

JAIPUR: Cooperation in sustainable and responsible tourism, skill development, use of artificial intelligence and facilitating seamless travel among BRICS countries were among the issues discussed at the second BRICS 2026 Tourism Working Group meeting held here on Wednesday. The meeting was chaired by Tourism Secretary Bhuvnesh Kumar and attended by delegates from BRICS member states, according to an official statement.

Mizoram panel flags projects

AIZAWL: An impact study committee on the Kaladan Multi-Modal Transit Transport Project (KMMTTP) and Bairabi-Sairang railway link has flagged the need for advance preparations in Mizoram to maximise the benefits of the two projects. The committee submitted its final draft report to Chief Minister Lalduhoma on Wednesday.

DEMANDS PM'S APOLOGY ON 'SHUDDHIKARAN'

Congress to take 'paper-leak', 'chanda chori' fight to grassroots

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Congress on Wednesday resolved to corner the government on the issues of paper leaks, the overall education system, as well as "chanda chori" at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya at the grassroots level.

The opposition party also alleged that the government was following a "surrender policy" with "Chinese incursions" taking place in Arunachal Pradesh.

The Congress Working Committee meeting was held at Indira Bhawan, with Kharge chairing it and top leaders, including former party chiefs Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, AICC general secretaries Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Jairam Ramesh and K C Venugopal, attending it.

Addressing a press conference, Venugopal said a detailed discussion was held at the CWC meeting with 88 leaders attending and 33 speaking on the occasion. "We are focused on three-four issues. Number one is paper leaks. The agitation done by the people of the country and the way the government dealt with that agitation was discussed. The CWC noted that the Monsoon Session of Parliament was successful for the Opposition and the government was on the back foot," he said.

Gandhi's 'Chhatron ki



Sonia Gandhi, Mallikarjun Kharge, KC Venugopal and Rahul Gandhi during the CWC meet on Wednesday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Addressing a press conference, Venugopal said a detailed discussion was held at the CWC meeting with 88 leaders attending and 33 speaking on the occasion
- » Congress president Kharge asked chief ministers from the party to work with education experts to come up with a roadmap to overhaul the education and examination system and submit a report to him, he said

Goonj' will continue with more such gatherings in 800 cities, some of which will be headed by the former Congress president.

Congress president Kharge asked chief ministers from the party to work

with education experts to come up with a roadmap to overhaul the education and examination system and submit a report to him, he said.

"Chanda Chori" is a serious area of concern

among people of this country. It is an issue associated with the sentiments of people. Those who used Ram Mandir for polarising people now stand exposed," Venugopal said.

"We will take this issue to the grassroots level. We directed PCCs to take it up at the village and panchayat level," he said.

Venugopal said the "Chinese incursion" in Arunachal was also discussed, he said.

It was reiterated that the Congress demands that women's reservation be implemented on the current strength of 543 seats

of the Lok Sabha, Venugopal said. Ramesh, who was at the press conference, demanded an apology from Prime Minister Narendra Modi to the country over the "shuddhikaran" in Uttarakhand after Kharge's programme there.

The CWC meeting was attended by senior leaders such as Ambika Sonia, Mukul Wasnik and P Chidambaram.

Congress chief ministers A Revanth Reddy (Telangana), V D Satheesan (Kerala), Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal Pradesh), and D K Shivakumar (Karnataka) were also present.

'No 60 km Chinese incursion in Arunachal': Rijiju

Admits delineation issue in state

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

Union Minister Kiren Rijiju has rejected reports that China has made a 60-km incursion into Arunachal Pradesh, while acknowledging that the lack of a clearly demarcated border has created disputes over certain stretches of territory.

According to reports, Rijiju said claims that China had entered deep inside Indian territory and occupied villages were incorrect. He said the situation should not be viewed as an occupation of Indian land.

"There is no question of China coming and capturing our village. That is not the case," he said.

Rijiju said the absence of demarcation has resulted in competing territorial claims along parts of the border. While people on the Indian side believe their territory extends further, villages and residents on the Chinese side, including Tibetan and local populations, make similar claims over land on the other side. He was responding to concerns over increased Chinese activity around Longju in Arunachal Pradesh.

Army, ITBP step up patrolling

Rijiju said the Army and the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) have intensified patrolling in the region.

He also referred to a



HE SAID SPREADING MISINFORMATION CREATES CONFUSION AMONG PEOPLE AND HARMS THE MORALE OF THE ARMED FORCES

village constructed ahead of Longju, where the Chinese People's Liberation Army (PLA) has built structures resembling a settlement. According to Rijiju, the area was occupied by China in 1959 and consolidated further in 1962.

"Travel and movement between China and India there have remained closed since after 1962," he said, while noting that Chinese military activity on high ridges had increased.

Rijiju criticised reports claiming that China had entered 60 km into Indian territory, saying such claims undermine the morale of troops and security personnel deployed along the border.

He said spreading misinformation creates confusion among people and harms the morale of the armed forces.

Shah to visit TN, Bengal; chair Southern Zonal Council meet

NARESH BISWANI
New Delhi, August 19

Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah will be addressing the 31st Meeting of the Southern Zonal Council (SZC) to be held in Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu on 20th August, wherein emphasis will be laid on enhancing Centre-State and inter-State cooperation on matters of common regional and national interest.

The Southern Zonal Council consists of the States of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana, Union Territories of Puducherry, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep. The meeting will be held at the Secretariat level and will provide a forum for deliberations on matters of common interest to the member States and Union Territories, including policy issues, planning and coordination between States, and Centre-State relations.

The meeting will be organised by the Inter-State Council Secretariat, under the Ministry of Home Affairs, and will be hosted by the Government of Tamil Nadu. The Chief Ministers, Lieutenant Governors and Administrators of the States and Union Territories, and two members from each State at the level of Ministers will constitute the participants.

In addition, Chief Secretaries, adviser-level officers, senior-most officials of States and UTs, and senior-most officials of the Government of India will also attend the meeting. These councils have been constituted under Sections 15 to 22 of the States Reorganisation Act, 1956.

BJP brings Smriti back into UP plan

BISWAJEET BANERJEE
Lucknow, August 19

The return of former Union minister Smriti Irani to the BJP's national organisation has added a familiar and combative face to the party's preparations for the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections, with the leadership expected to use her political appeal, oratory and connect with women voters to strengthen its campaign in the state.

Irani has been appointed national general secretary in BJP president Nitin Nabin's new team, making her one of eight leaders from Uttar Pradesh to get key organisational responsibilities. Her appointment is particularly significant as she had remained without a major organisational role after losing the Amethi Lok Sabha seat in 2024.

Irani represented Amethi from 2019 to 2024 and emerged as one of the BJP's most prominent national

leaders during her decade in the Modi government. Her political career in Uttar Pradesh, however, has been closely associated with her battle against the Gandhi family.

She first contested Amethi against Rahul Gandhi in 2014 and lost. Rather than withdrawing from the constituency, she continued visiting Amethi and maintained contact with voters and party workers. Five years later, she defeated Rahul Gandhi in a direct contest, ending the Gandhi family's long hold over the seat and earning the tag of a "giant killer".

Her defeat in 2024 to Congress candidate Kishori Lal Sharma marked a sharp reversal.

She subsequently lost her ministerial position and was not given a major responsibility in the BJP organisation. Her latest appointment has therefore been seen by party workers as a political comeback.

Cong defies Vande Mataram protocol

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Congress Working Committee on Wednesday decided to abide by the 1937 resolution of its highest decision-making body on Vande Mataram, saying only two stanzas of the National Song would be sung at all party events henceforth. The Congress decision came after the BJP accused its leaders of insulting Vande Mataram by not singing the full version at party events.

Congress general secretary KC Venugopal said the party's stand is very clear, and it stands behind the decision of its top leadership in 1937. "Our stand is very clear that the 1937 resolution decided in which Mahatma Gandhi, Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, Rabin-drath Tagore, Subhas Chandra Bose and Sardar Patel - the top-most leadership of the party at that point of time were present."

Tejashwi detained during march against NEET crackdown

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Patna, August 19

RJD working president Tejashwi Yadav on Wednesday braved water cannons before being detained in Patna, where he was leading thousands of supporters during a march to the Lok Bhawan over the recent police action on students who demonstrated against the NEET paper leak.

Yadav, also the Leader of Opposition in the Bihar assembly, was bundled into a police van, along with key aides like Rajya Sabha MPs Sanjay Yadav and Manoj Jha, besides eldest sister Misa Bharti, and were taken to the Sachivalaya police station.

Emerging from the police station, Bharti, who had to get off the vehicle mid-way and take an e-rickshaw after a tyre of the "overloaded bus" got deflated, told reporters: "We have been let off. We were asked to give our name and address. We gave



Tejashwi Yadav breaches the barricades during the march PTI

them our full bio-data".

Tejashwi Yadav said that "our march was disrupted, but our fight will continue till accountability is fixed for the incident in Siwan district last month when a police personnel had fired at students from an AK-47 rifle".

The allusion was to an episode on July 25, when Left-leaning students unions had called for a 'Bihar bandh' in protest against the paper leaks.

Later, the constable was placed under suspension, and, on Tuesday, the then

SP Pooran Kumar Jha, was transferred though many of the protesters taking part in the Lok Bhawan march said they wanted the Superintendent of Police and the District Magistrate to be suspended.

"We learn that the Governor is out of station. So, a delegation of our party will meet the Additional Chief Secretary concerned and submit a memorandum," Yadav, a former deputy chief minister, said.

The march by the opposition party came under sharp attack from the NDA.

One minister, one univ a day: Modi govt's Gen Z push

Centre plans direct campus outreach to connect with young voters

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 19

The initiative comes in the backdrop of student protests on the NEET paper leak issue at Jantar Mantar in Delhi and in other parts of the country.

Under the 'One Day, One University' programme, a Union Minister will visit an assigned university to interact with students, listen to their views on different subjects, and inform them about various government welfare schemes, particularly those for youth and students, sources aware

KEY POINTS

- » It is learnt that Education Minister Pralhad Joshi and Youth Affairs and Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya have been given the responsibility to coordinate with the universities and the ministers for the visits
- » According to the University Grants Commission, there are as many as 1,300 universities in the country, including 57 central universities and 522 state universities, while others are either deemed-to-be or private universities



of the initiative told PTI. It is learnt that Education Minister Pralhad Joshi and Youth Affairs and Sports

Minister Mansukh Mandaviya have been given the responsibility to coordinate with the universities

and the ministers for the visits.

The planned initiative also figured at a meeting of

the Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Wednesday, the sources said.

According to the University Grants Commission, there are as many as 1,300 universities in the country, including 57 central universities and 522 state universities, while others are either deemed-to-be or private universities.

The police crackdown on protesting students here on July 20 had led to a massive backlash, with the Opposition disrupting proceedings during the Monsoon session of Parliament. Amidst the student

protests, Dharmendra Pradhan had to resign as education minister on July 25. Prime Minister Modi himself reached out to the students through social media on multiple occasions. In his Independence Day address also, PM Modi announced a slew of youth-centric initiatives including free online coaching, an AI skilling programme, a sports talent hunt and widening of the civil defence network, while listing out opportunities for them in areas ranging from manufacturing, space and nuclear to semiconductors.

48-HOUR GENERAL STRIKE ENDS ON WEDNESDAY

Manipur NRC stir: Protesters show anger over politicians

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Imphal, August 19

Protesters burnt effigies of politicians and took out rallies in different parts of Manipur's valley districts as the 48-hour general strike demanding updation of the NRC ended on Wednesday.

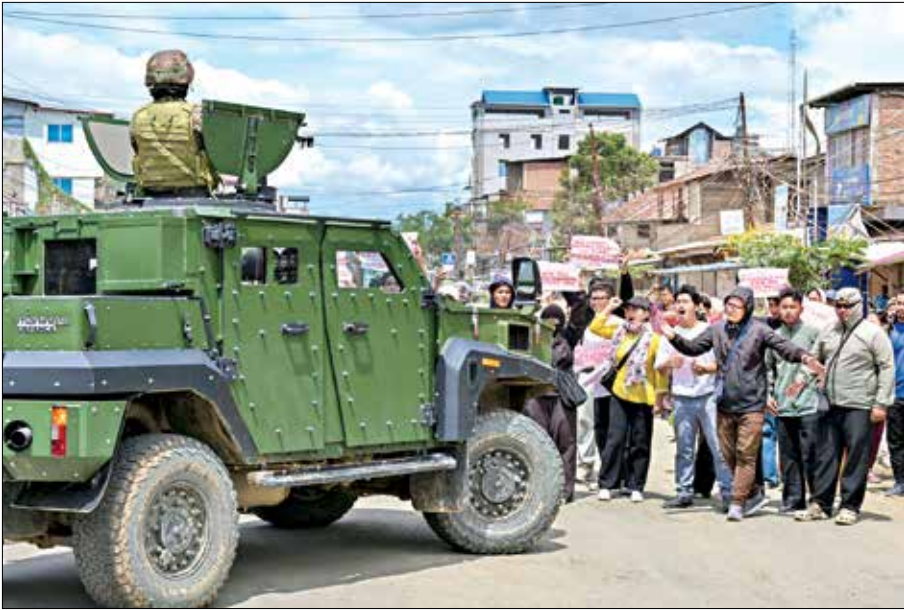
The strike had been called by the Campaign for Just and Fair Delimitation (JFD) to press for an update of the National Register of Citizens (NRC) before the Census exercise was conducted in the state.

At Khurai Lamlong in Imphal East district, bandh supporters burnt effigies of Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh and Home minister Govindas Konthoujam.

They raised slogans such as "No NRC, No Census" and demanded that the census not be conducted until internally displaced persons (IDPs) return to their native places.

Dozens of demonstrators also took out a protest rally at Singjamei in Imphal West district and marched for nearly 2 km to press their demands.

Road blockades continued at several locations in Imphal West, Imphal East, Bishnupur and Thoubal districts, with bandh supporters stopping private vehicles as well as security forces from proceeding and asking them to return.



Demonstrators block the movement of security personnel and vehicles on the second day of a 48-hour statewide strike, in Imphal East district, Wednesday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Dozens of demonstrators also took out a protest rally at Singjamei in Imphal West district and marched for nearly 2 km to press their demands
- » JFD announced that it would boycott state and Central government offices from Thursday as the next phase of its agitation

ceeding and asking them to return.

A census training programme for supervisors, enumerators and field trainers was also cancelled in Thoubal district, officials said.

Meanwhile, the Council of Teachers' Associations (COTA), Manipur, said it was "highly aggrieved" by

the circumstances under which census enumeration training was being conducted.

"Teachers assigned as enumerators and supervisors for the Census are facing embarrassment, humiliation and different forms of obstacles while attending training sessions complying with

the government orders," it said.

COTA appealed to the state government and civil society organisations (CSOs) agitating for NRC updation before the census enumeration to find an amicable solution at the earliest.

Meanwhile, the JFD announced that it would boycott state and Central government offices from Thursday as the next phase of its agitation.

"Essential services including water, power and medical will, however, be exempted from the boycott," JFD convenor Jeetendra Ningomba told reporters.

Haryana Cong protests in support of skilled workers

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 19

The Congress party staged a massive protest on Wednesday demanding the regularisation of all personnel recruited under the Kaushal Rozgar Nigam (HKRN).

Thousands of Congress members who reached the HKRN office were stopped by police barricades, they raised slogans and voiced their demands.

The protest was led by former Chief Minister and Leader of the Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda and state president Rao Narendra.

Party MPs Deepender, Varun Mulana, Satpal Brahmachari, and Karmbir Baudh; organiser Chander Mohan; convenors Ashok Arora, Virender Singh, and Udaybhan; Deputy Leader Kuldeep Sharma and Aftab, along with all MLAs, former MPs, former MLAs, senior leaders, and thousands of party workers were present on the occasion.



ent on the occasion.

"We demand that all employees recruited via HKRN be regularised in government service and granted equal pay scales, Dearness Allowance (DA), promotion avenues, reservation benefits, and retirement benefits. Also, all future appointments should be made through regular recruitment processes," Hooda said.

Hooda remarked that the government's primary duty is to conduct regular recruitments, yet the BJP government is promoting the contract system by filling even gazetted posts through the HKRN.

Assam: Train stopped to help avert elephant-train collision

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Guwahati, August 19

Officials of the Assam Forest Department coordinated with Railway officials to facilitate the timely stoppage of Rajdhani Express in the Lumding-Habaipur section during the early morning hours. The prompt action enabled a herd of elephants to cross the railway track safely.

A major tragedy was averted in Assam's Hojai district on Wednesday when forest personnel alerted the Rajdhani Express after spotting a large herd of elephants crossing a railway track, Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma said.



EXAM STIR SUSPENDED AFTER 26 DAYS

J'khand: Those fearing job loss as govt cancels tests move HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Ranchi, August 19

The 26-day stir over alleged irregularities in Jharkhand's recruitment exams was suspended on Wednesday, with protesters giving the Hemant Soren government two months to address their grievances, even as those fearing job loss over exam cancellations moved the high court.

Following several rounds of talks with the exam protesters, the state government decided to cancel 22 job exams and order a probe into 23 others conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC), Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC) and an outsourced agency since 2014.

The decision and the government conceding to several other demands of the protesters quelled the



One of the successful JSSC-CGL candidates holds a placard during a protest, in Ranchi, Wednesday PTI

stir for now.

Of the six exam protesters who were on indefinite hunger strike, three -- Rupesh Kumar Pal, Savita Kumari and Rahul Kranti -- of the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch, which has been spearheading the agitation, ended their fast after 15 days on Wednesday.

Jharkhand Loktantrik

Krantikari Morcha (JLKM) leader Devendra Mahto ended his 16-day hunger strike on Monday. Two protesters, Prem Nayak and Umme Habiba, ended the fast the next day.

However, the JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch on Wednesday warned they would intensify the stir if the government failed to address their demands within the stipulated period.

A leader of the Manch said, "We are suspending the stir, giving a two-month ultimatum to the government to resolve the issues and conduct a fair probe into recruitment exam irregularities."

On the flip side, the exam cancellation decision triggered a separate protest by around 2,000 successful candidates, particularly those recruited through the JSSC Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination.

CM Saini interacts with international students

MPOST BUREAU
Chandigarh, August 19

The Foreign Cooperation Department is making sustained efforts to connect Haryana with the world through a 'Go Global' approach and expand international opportunities for the youth.

As part of these efforts, Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini, on Wednesday, interacted with a delegation of international stu-



dents studying at various universities in Haryana at his residence, Sant Kabir Kutir.

Students from 14 countries studying at Chaudhary Charan Singh Haryana

Agricultural University, Hissar, Kurukshetra University, Kurukshetra and Maharishi Markandeshwar University, Mullana, participated in the interaction. Meanwhile, Chief Minis-

'UGC-NET June 2026 exam to be conducted again in Sept'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The Centre on Wednesday informed the Delhi High Court that a retest is being conducted for three subjects, including Sociology, of the UGC-NET June 2026 examination following complaints of some errors in the questionnaires.

Taking note of the submission of Solicitor General (SG) Tushar Mehta, representing the Centre, Justice Jasmeet Singh disposed of a plea filed by a candidate, who appeared for the Sociology paper on June 30, seeking a stay on the declaration of results pending an independent probe and re-conduct of the exam following allegations of paper leak.

While the English and Commerce papers will be held on September 9, the Sociology paper will be held on September 10, the SG told the high court.

ter Saini will hold a direct interaction with Gen-Z entrepreneurs at Gurugram University on August 21.

During the programme, successful young entrepreneurs will not only guide youth aspiring to launch their own startups but will also provide them with information on various aspects, including raising funds and obtaining technical assistance for their ventures.

Chhattisgarh: Women take centre stage in governance

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Raipur, August 19



Chhattisgarh is emerging as a striking example of women's leadership in public administration, with the Vishnu Deo Sai government steadily increasing the representation of women officers in key positions across the state.

The latest administrative reshuffle announced on Tuesday has further strengthened this trend. With the appointment of Jayashree Jain as Collector of Sakti district and Tanuja Salam as Collector of Mohla-Manpur-Ambargarh Chowki, Chhattisgarh now has 12 women collectors among its 33 districts, more than one-third of the state's districts.

The latest reshuffle also saw Tulika Prajapati, already serving as a woman collector, move to Kabirdham district.

The development assumes significance because the collector is the administrative face of the govt at the district level, responsible for coordinating development programmes, revenue administration, law & order and delivery of public services.

The latest appointments build on a broader administrative shift initiated earlier this year. In May, the Chhattisgarh government had placed women officers in charge of 10 districts, including Betamara, Kondagaon, Narayanpur, Surajpur, Balrampur-Ramanujganj, Mohla-Manpur-Ambargarh Chowki, Balod, Koriya,

Briefs

Landslide hits Kulagad bridge

DEHRADUN: The Kulagad bridge on the Dharchula-Tawaghat road in the Pithoragarh district was damaged on Wednesday due to a landslide amid ongoing rains across various parts of Uttarakhand, officials said.

Officials from the Border Roads Organisation (BRO) said that the bridge was damaged due to falling stones and rocks.

Key agent held in 'cyber slavery'

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested a key agent of a network trafficking Indian nationals to scam compounds in Southeast Asia, promising them lucrative jobs overseas.

According to the CBI, the investigation agency has registered a case against a criminal network of agents and facilitators.

I&B officer arrested

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has arrested Sandeep, Deputy Controller of Accounts/ Internal Financial Advisor, Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, in an alleged bribery case worth Rs 10 lakh.

The CBI registered a case against the accused on a complaint alleging that Sandeep had demanded an undue advantage of Rs 15 lakh from the complainant.

AFTER CLEARANCE FROM UNION HOME AND PERSONNEL MINISTRIES

Top govt committee to finalise CAPF cadre review

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 19

The much-awaited cadre review of Group A officers of the five Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) is expected to be placed before a high-level government committee soon following clearances from the Union Home and Personnel ministries, officials said on Wednesday.

They told the news agency that the proposals are currently with the Department of Expenditure (DoE) under the Union Finance Ministry. They will be placed before a high-level cadre review com-

KEY POINTS

- » The Supreme Court's May 2025 order necessitated a comprehensive cadre review and revision of recruitment rules for Group A executive cadre officers of the five CAPFs -- CRPF, BSF, SSB, CISF and ITBP
- » The court issued the direction based on petitions filed by a group of CAPF officers



mittee, usually chaired by the Cabinet Secretary, for final deliberations and recommendations.

Cadre restructuring improves career prospects for an organisation's personnel.

The Supreme Court's

May 2025 order necessitated a comprehensive cadre review and revision of recruitment rules for Group A executive cadre officers of the five CAPFs -- Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF), Border Security Force (BSF), Sashastra

Seema Bal (SSB), Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) and Indo Tibetan Border Police (ITBP).

The court issued the direction based on petitions filed by a group of CAPF officers who had fought a years-long legal

battle seeking better promotion prospects amid long delays in moving up the ranks compared to Indian Police Service (IPS) officers posted in these forces on deputation.

The Union government filed a review petition against the apex court judgement, which was rejected in October 2025. Subsequently, the government enacted the CAPFs (General Administration) Act in April this year.

Following the rejection of the review petition, the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) directed the five CAPFs to undertake a "comprehensive and

detailed" review of their existing Group A cadres and submit the proposals to the ministry for implementation of the court's order.

The MHA received the proposals from the five forces between May and July and subsequently sent them to the Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) between July and August as per prescribed procedure, officials said.

The DoPT followed the set procedure and forwarded the reviews to the DoE on August 17 along with its observations and recommendations, they said.

EDITORIAL

Debating State Execution

The Supreme Court’s decision to uphold hanging as India’s constitutionally permissible method of execution answers one question while leaving a more fundamental one unsettled. A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta has rejected a challenge arguing that hanging is inherently painful, unpredictable and incompatible with the dignity guaranteed by Article 21. The Court found insufficient evidence to overturn the 1983 *Deena v Union of India* judgment, which held that properly administered long-drop hanging was neither barbaric nor degrading. It also noted Parliament’s recent choice to retain hanging under Section 393(5) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita. The petitioners had cited research suggesting that hanging does not invariably produce the cervical fracture intended to cause rapid unconsciousness. The Union countered that alternatives are hardly foolproof: lethal injection, particularly in the United States, has produced documented botched executions. Importantly, the Court did not pronounce hanging eternally humane. It acknowledged that constitutional protection “does not cease to exist at the gallops” and left room for reconsideration if stronger scientific evidence emerges.

That qualification matters. The debate cannot simply become a technological search for the least painful way to kill. India’s own institutional record has long raised doubts about capital punishment. The Law Commission’s 187th Report in 2003 recommended introducing lethal injection as an alternative to hanging; its 262nd Report in 2015 went much further, recommending abolition of the death penalty for ordinary crimes while retaining it for terrorism-related offences and waging war. Meanwhile, the judiciary has progressively narrowed its application since *Bachan Singh v State of Punjab* established the “rarest of rare” doctrine. Yet death sentences continue to be imposed frequently at the trial stage and overturned or commuted higher up. Research on the decade from 2016 to 2025 records 1,279 people receiving death sentences. In 2024 alone, trial courts imposed 139 death sentences, while the Supreme Court confirmed none for the second consecutive year. Such divergence is consequential when the punishment is irreversible. It suggests that the reliability of sentencing deserves at least as much scrutiny as the mechanics of execution.

The government should therefore accept the Court’s invitation to examine alternatives through experts, but give that exercise a wider mandate. Doctors and forensic specialists can assess pain, unconsciousness and the possibility of failed executions; jurists and criminologists must examine arbitrariness, deterrence and sentencing consistency. The central question is no longer whether hanging was considered humane in 1983, but whether the State’s ultimate punishment continues to satisfy contemporary constitutional standards. India has executed only eight people since 2003, according to the Union’s submission before the Court. That restraint makes a broader review both possible and necessary. A constitutional democracy should continually demand stronger justification when the State takes a life. The judgment preserves hanging for now; it should begin, rather than conclude, a serious reconsideration of capital punishment itself.

LETTER



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Grave Negligence

The alleged discovery of gloves and paper inside a woman’s abdomen after a C-section in Beed is deeply disturbing. The inquiry must establish accountability across the surgical team, not merely one doctor. Government hospitals must enforce rigorous operating-room protocols to ensure such preventable lapses never recur.

PRERANA VERMA,
SIKANDRABAD

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Care Behind Fading Memories

With a looming dementia surge, ARDSI Calcutta shows how awareness, early diagnosis, caregiver support and community-based services can build a humane model of care

NEXUS OF GOOD



ANIL SWARUP

THE WRITER IS AN AUTHOR AND A FORMER CIVIL SERVANT

The occasion was an event organised by the Kolkata City Chapter of Nexus of Good, wherein a presentation was made by Alzheimer’s & Related Disorders Society of India (ARDSI), an organisation that is doing such marvellous work in the context of care and support.

ARDSI’s Calcutta chapter was registered in 2000. The members of ARDSI Calcutta comprise family caregivers of persons with dementia, professional caregivers, specialised dementia care experts, eminent doctors, including practising neurologists, psychiatrists, neuropsychologists and geriatricians, professionals from different fields, eminent personalities from various walks of society, social workers and persons having compassion and passion for working for the elderly and those afflicted by dementia. ARDSI Calcutta is thus endowed with rich, multidirectional expertise and experience devoted to its mission.

At the beginning, the society was mainly an information dissemination hub. Most of the board members were medical professionals and family caregivers.

From 2000 until 2007, the society was mainly run by volunteers.



ARDSI shows how compassionate care can make dementia more manageable

Over the years, it has successfully included awareness campaigns, memory screening camps, a memory clinic, counselling, home visits, training programmes for families and professionals, home companionship, daycare services and a rural outreach programme for society, along with other members of the team.

The dementia population accounts for 8.8 million in India. This number will increase to 17.39 million by 2050 and calls for immediate intervention from society at large to tackle the epidemic.

Awareness camps: The most fundamental and important activity, as people need to be empowered with full knowledge of the disease, the imminent epidemic and the problems and costs associated with it. All stigma, misunderstanding and misinformation should be eradicated. It needs to be understood that dementia is a disease of progressive, irreversible degeneration of the brain and is neither a

CENTRE-BASED COMMUNITY DEMENTIA CARE REMAINS VITAL FOR THERAPY AND IMPROVING EVERYDAY LIFE

part of normal ageing nor insanity; that there are preventive measures which, if practised in our lifestyle, certainly increase the chance of not falling victim to the disease; that there is a need to be cautious about the early warning signs of dementia and get our brain health assessed to ensure early diagnosis if the disease sets in.

ARDSI Calcutta regularly holds awareness sessions/camps, arranges talks aided by computer presentations, video shows, etc., and develops and

distributes information materials like quarterly newsletters, brochures, etc. We also recently started the “Dementia Friendly Community” initiative, where trained dementia workers visit shops, banks, pharmacies and other establishments in the locality to talk about dementia.

Memory Screening camps: This is a facility that gives people the opportunity to get their memory health status assessed. This very preliminary assessment comes in very handy in proceeding to the next level of assessment, if required.

Memory Clinic: This is a structured service offered by ARDSI, which is jointly conducted by neurologists, psychologists and care counsellors. Here, a thorough assessment is undertaken and, if found necessary, people are advised to undergo investigative tests for a specific diagnosis.

Care Counselling: The right kind of caregiving is central to dementia treatment. ARDSI Calcutta provides specialised coun-

selling at its office and patients’ homes to help family caregivers develop appropriate care plans.

Home visits: Many a time, a home visit helps us assess a person with dementia and their family caregivers in their home environment and give them guidance and a valuable care plan to maintain a quality of life.

Helpline: This line operates six days a week for six hours a day and is managed by a trained person. It addresses issues related to care, treatment and referrals.

Home companionship: There are several people with dementia who prefer engagement in their home environment due to their limited mobility or personal choice. Here, trained caregivers are sent to provide two hours of service that mainly focuses on activities.

Carer Support Initiatives: Family caregivers need emotional and technical support and regular respite from caregiving to maintain quality caregiving. Towards this end, ARDSI Calcutta imparts care counselling and training to improve care skills and holds carer support group sessions where family caregivers can have some free, light and enjoyable time sharing their experiences and also discussing practical care tips.

Daycare: ARDSI Calcutta launched its first daycare centre in 2008 to provide the double benefits of better and specialised care to persons with dementia and respite for family members. Centre-based community care is an indispensable part of dementia therapy, which goes a long way towards improving the quality of life, especially in the early and middle stages of the disease.

Dementia care calls for very in-depth training of professionals. The purpose of the training and development function is to organise and facilitate learning and development.

What ARDSI is doing is a wonderful example of Nexus of Good that can be scaled through public-private partnership.

Views expressed are personal

AI Gets Reined In

Faster service through AI means little if customers cannot reach a human

HUMAN OVERRIDE



SOUVIK SINGHA

THE WRITER IS AN ASSISTANT PROFESSOR AT OP JINDAL UNIVERSITY

That is less an oversight than a sequencing effect, and India’s sequence has been quick. The Reserve Bank’s FREE-AI committee proposed in August 2025 that citizens be told when they are interacting with AI and be able to challenge its decisions. The Ministry of Electronics and IT followed with national AI governance guidelines in November. Binding rules on synthetic media took effect in February. Each addressed the surface most visible at the time: the credit decision, the deepfake, the underwriting model.

Customer service is the newest of those surfaces, and the stakes there are different. Service automation operates at the point of repair, when something has already gone wrong and what happens next can decide whether the relationship survives. The synthetic-media rules, for instance, cover audio and video but not text, so a text chatbot sits outside the country’s only binding AI-labelling regime. That is a natural place for a first rule to stop. It is also a natural moment to think about the next one.

Much of the world is working through the same sequence. The European Union’s obligation to tell people they are interacting with an AI system became applicable on 2 August. Since 19 June, EU consumers buying financial services remotely have also had a right to human intervention. Spain went furthest, legislating in December 2025 for a right to a human operator, with 95 per cent of calls to be answered within three minutes. The direction is consistent; the pace is not.



India’s chatbot rules must extend beyond banks to everyone

RBI’S PROPOSED AI SAFEGUARDS FOR CUSTOMERS DESERVE APPLICATION FAR BEYOND BANKING

India has particular reason to care, and the reason is a success rather than a failure. Indian firms have built service automation at impressive scale. Air India’s assistant handles about 40,000 queries a day. IRCTC’s AskDISHA answers roughly 1,50,000 queries in thirteen languages. Meesho’s voice bot takes 60,000 calls. ServiceNow surveys find eight in ten Indians now use chatbots, while 82 per cent say AI has raised their

service expectations. The more volume that flows through automation, the more consequential the small share that does not resolve.

Air India reports that about three per cent of conversations now reach a person, down from roughly 15 per cent at launch. But containment is not resolution: a customer who gives up is still counted as contained. Making the bot friendlier or more human-like can misfire where help is most needed. A study of 461,689 real chatbot conversations in the Journal of Marketing found that a more human-seeming bot lowered satisfaction among customers who were already angry, because it raised expectations it could not meet. Warmth is not the fix. The exit is.

Three things follow for firms. Measure resolution rather than containment, and publish it – no large Indian company currently

discloses whether its chatbot actually solved the customer’s problem. Design the handoff as a deliberate moment, with a stated trigger, so the bot does not decide whether the bot is working. And say plainly, at the outset, that the customer is speaking to a machine – an ordinary courtesy which, on the available evidence, costs a firm very little precisely where the machine cannot help.

Three follow for policy. The Reserve Bank should finalise its guidance with the disclosure and human-escalation provisions intact. The principle should then find a wider home, because the right to know one is dealing with a machine, and to reach a human, should not depend on which regulator supervises the firm. Consumer-protection law is the natural vehicle: the Central Consumer Protection Authority already regulates interface design through its dark-patterns guidelines, and this is the same family of concern. And when an automated system mishandles a grievance, the Ombudsman should be able to rule on that directly, not only on its downstream cost.

None of this restrains anything. Calls to the National Consumer Helpline rose from about 62,000 in December 2019 to more than 359,000 in December 2025; unresolved complaints do not disappear; they migrate. “Innovation over Restraint” is the Reserve Bank’s own principle, and a reliable way back to a human being is among the conditions under which people will keep using these systems long enough for the innovation to pay for itself.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Ukrainian man arrested over 2022 Nord Stream explosions

BERLIN: A Ukrainian man wanted in Germany in connection with the 2022 undersea explosions that damaged the Nord Stream gas pipelines was arrested on a European warrant in Croatia on Wednesday, Germany’s federal prosecutor said.

The German prosecutors said that the suspect was a “trained scuba diver” who belonged to a group of people who “planted explosives” on the Nord Stream 1 and Nord Stream 2 gas pipelines in the Baltic Sea near the Danish island of Bornholm.

Congo’s Ebola outbreak reaches 5,000 cases

BUNIA: The Ebola outbreak in Congo has reached 5,000 cases, government data showed on Wednesday, as responders warn it is spreading at an unprecedented speed, outpacing efforts to slow it in one of the country’s remotest regions.

Data from Congo’s Ministry of Health showed the outbreak had so far recorded 5,021 cases, including 2,378 deaths as of Sunday, as it rages in some of the most challenging conditions, fuelled by insecurity, displacement and intense population movements.

Indian-origin couple killed in light aircraft crash in UK

LONDON: An inquest on Wednesday identified an Indian-origin couple in their 50s as the two victims who died on the spot after their light aircraft crashed at a remote location in northern Wales.

Ketan Swali is believed to have been the pilot of the Piper PA28 aircraft and was accompanied by his wife, Sheetal, as they took off from Tatenhill Airport in Burton-upon-Trent in the West Midlands region of England last week. North Wales Police said air and ground searches were launched on Friday.



A silhouette of visitors against the backdrop of a setting sun over the horizon at the Galle Fort, in Galle, Sri Lanka on Wednesday

PTI

Briefs

Helicopter crashes in Kenya

NAIROBI: A helicopter with seven people on board crashed Wednesday morning in a remote part of northern Kenya, the country’s aviation agency said. The fate of the passengers and the pilot wasn’t immediately known.

The helicopter crashed at 9:13 a.m. while flying from the Loisaba Conservancy to the Ewaso Nyiro area in Samburu County.

The aviation authority said the aircraft was a Eurocopter EC130 B4. The Kenya Red Cross said that its emergency response teams were “participating in a multi-agency response effort as rescue teams work to access the crash site.”

Syrian FM to visit Pak

ISLAMABAD: Syrian Foreign Minister Asaad Hassan al-Shaibani will arrive in Pakistan on Wednesday night on a two-day official visit to discuss bilateral cooperation and international development.

This will be the first visit by a Syrian foreign minister to Pakistan in 19 years. Then Foreign Minister Walid al-Mouallem travelled to Pakistan in May 2007. He is travelling to Pakistan at the invitation of Deputy Prime Minister and Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar.

Israel to investigate Gaza attacks

JERUSALEM: The Israeli military said Wednesday it will conduct criminal investigations into the killings of a five-year-old Palestinian girl and her family and the separate killings of 15 paramedics, following a review of troop conduct during the war in Gaza.

Meanwhile, France announced that it will expel two Iranian diplomats in response to the expulsion of French diplomats from the Islamic Republic earlier this week, while the Iranian parliament speaker and chief negotiator landed in neighbouring Iraq for a three-day visit.

The Israeli military said Wednesday that it would investigate the killings of five-year-old Hind Rajab and her family members in February 2024.

TEHRAN REJECTS CLAIMS, CALLS IT ‘BASELESS’

UAE suspends trade with Iran after coming under renewed missile fire

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Dubai, August 19

The United Arab Emirates suspended all trade with Iran on Wednesday after it said it had come under renewed fire from the country – a move that will further isolate the Islamic Republic, which is suffering under US sanctions and a blockade.

Incoming ballistic missile fire triggered nationwide warnings Tuesday night for UAE residents to seek shelter, the first time in weeks such an alarm had sounded.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei denied that Iran had launched any missiles toward the UAE.

Early in the conflict, the UAE regularly came under intense fire from Iran, and most trade between the countries, which had once been important trading partners, ground to a halt. In late June, as hostilities eased, some maritime trade resumed, Iran’s state-run IRNA news agency reported.

More time and data are



Representational image

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei denied that Iran had launched any missiles toward the UAE
- » The UAE’s Defence Ministry said assessments showed that the missiles targeted maritime traffic

needed to evaluate the full effect of the war on Iran-UAE trade, but the UAE is

clearly a critical partner for Iran, said Mohammad Farzanegan, a professor of

Middle Eastern economics at Germany’s University of Marburg.

Beyond the trade in domestically produced goods, “the UAE has been very important for Iran as a re-export hub and has helped the country absorb some of the shocks caused by sanctions,” he told The Associated Press. “Iran therefore depends heavily

on the UAE not because the UAE itself produces one-third of Iran’s imports, but because it serves as a major gateway for Iran to access third-country goods and commercial infrastructure.”

Following the news that two ballistic missiles had been fired toward the UAE, both of which splashed down in the Persian Gulf late Tuesday, the Foreign Ministry said that while it remained committed to “dialogue, cooperation and regional integration,” it had decided to impose the punitive measures.

“In light of regional escalations that undermine regional and international peace and security, all trade, commercial exchanges and financial transactions with Iran have been halted until further notice,” the ministry said in a statement.

The UAE’s Defence Ministry said assessments showed that the missiles targeted maritime traffic. It was not clear whether they targeted Emirati ships or the country’s territorial waters.

Zelenskyy fires a top aide amid graft probe

This comes a day after Ukraine’s recently fired defense minister



ASSOCIATED PRESS

Kyiv, August 19

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy fired one of his most senior officials Wednesday as corruption investigators named a deputy head of the presidential office among the suspects in a money-laundering case.

The stunning developments came a day after Ukraine’s recently fired defense minister demanded national elections, despite Russia’s more than 4-year-old invasion.

Although Zelenskyy was not implicated in the graft investigation, it threatened to pull him into another political crisis and pro-

vide another test of his resilience. Investigators gave few details of the probe. It has identified a group of people alleged to have laundered 150 million hryvnias to pay bail for a defendant in a major graft case last year, the National Anti-Corruption Bureau said.

“IT HAS IDENTIFIED A GROUP OF PEOPLE ALLEGED TO HAVE LAUNDERED 150 MILLION HRYVNIAS TO PAY BAIL FOR A DEFENDANT IN A MAJOR GRAFT CASE LAST YEAR’

China successfully recovers rocket stage on land for 1st time

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Beijing, August 19

China has successfully recaptured the first stage of a rocket on land for the first time, state media reported Wednesday.

Although this marks China’s first successful recovery on land, it is the second time the country has recovered a rocket stage, following a successful recovery on a sea platform in July.

Chinese state news agency Xinhua said the reusable rocket, Zhuque-3, developed by private aerospace company LandSpace, was launched on Wednesday morning and that the rocket’s first stage was recovered afterwards.



Elon Musk’s SpaceX and Jeff Bezos’ Blue Origin have been recovering rockets since 2015, helping drive down launch costs by reusing hardware that would otherwise be discarded after carrying satellites and other payloads toward space.

Xinhua said that

Wednesday’s recovery also marked China’s first use of deployable landing legs and deemed the result “a major breakthrough in the country’s reusable rocket technology.”

On July 10, the first stage of a Long March-10B rocket separated from the second stage after lift-off and returned to a platform at sea. That time, it was recovered using a net-capture system.

The next day, Japan conducted the first test flight of an experimental reusable rocket, which took off and landed safely.

Japan is also trying to catch up with the technology needed to cut launch costs and compete in the global space market.

B’desh to hold presidential polls today

The voting will take place for the first time after a gap of 35 years

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Dhaka, August 19

Bangladesh will hold its presidential election on Thursday, with lawmakers set to choose between the ruling BNP stalwart Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir and 11-party opposition alliance candidate Colonel (retd) Oli Ahmed.

The voting will take place for the first time in a presidential election after a gap of 35 years.

The voting will be held at the parliament (Jatiya Sangsad) from 2:00 pm to 5 pm on August 20, according to the Election Commission.

Alamgir, 78, is the candidate of the ruling Ban-



Bangladesh’s former President Mohammed Shahabuddin (left) with PM Tarique Rahman

PTI

gladesh Nationalist Party (BNP), while Colonel (retd) Ahmed, Bir Bikram, chairman of the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP), is contesting as the candidate of the Jamaat-e-Islami-led 11-party opposition

alliance.

The Election Commission declared their nomination papers valid on August 16.

Speaking at the BNP parliamentary party meeting on Wednesday, Alam-

gir appealed to the BNP lawmakers to vote for him in Thursday’s presidential election.

“If I have made any mistake or unintentionally hurt anyone during my tenure, I seek forgiveness,” said Alamgir, who has served as BNP’s Senior Joint Secretary General, Acting Secretary General and Secretary General.

US green card seekers to face fresh hurdles from Sept 18

Of nearly 1.2mn people who received a green card in 2023, 7% were from India

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Washington, August 19



Immigrants seeking green cards or permanent residency in the US will face fresh hurdles as the Trump administration has expanded the definition of “public charge” to deny applications to those availing benefits such as Medicaid, food stamps or any subsistence aid from the government.

The new rule finalized by the US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) comes into effect

KEY POINTS

- » The final rule was announced on July 16 and published in the Federal Register on July 20
- » It will apply to Forms I-485 seeking permanent residence or adjustment of status that are postmarked or electronically submitted on or after September 18

from September 18 and will also hit Indians seeking green cards.

An earlier rule only considered two types of public benefits as grounds for denying a green card application: cash assis-

tance for income maintenance and long-term institutionalisation at the government’s expense.

“To make public charge inadmissibility determinations, USCIS officers will consider

the five statutory factors and any other factor relevant to assessing the alien’s likelihood at any time of becoming a public charge, including the alien’s receipt of means-tested public benefits, such as cash assistance for income maintenance, housing assistance, food stamps, financial aid for college, or any other similar benefit,” an official statement said.

The guidance follows the Department of Homeland Security’s decision to rescind the 2022 Biden-

era public charge regulations. The final rule was announced on July 16 and published in the Federal Register on July 20. It will apply to Forms I-485 seeking permanent residence or adjustment of status that are postmarked or electronically submitted on or after September 18.

The new rule allows USCIS officers to count age, health, family status, finances, educational background, and even the use of public benefits by an applicant’s dependents.

News at a glance

No new SIMs to subscribers having 9 connections: Govt

NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecommunications has directed telecom operators to decline new connections to subscribers already having nine mobile SIMs in their name, according to an official circular.

Telecom operators, in the circular dated August 17, have been asked to put in place appropriate technical and organisational measures from August 24 onwards to identify each subscriber seeking to obtain a connection beyond the prescribed limit and deny them new SIM cards.

Hindustan Copper to invest over Rs 7K cr in expansion

NEW DELHI: State-owned Hindustan Copper Ltd, in a regulatory filing on Tuesday, said it plans to invest over Rs 7,000 crore over the next five to six years as part of an expansion drive covering exploration, mine revivals and partnerships.

The company said it has added 135.52 million tonnes of copper ore reserves and resources in three years. It is pursuing new copper deposits in India and overseas and plans to reopen closed mines. It has also partnered with Chile's CODELCO for technical cooperation.

Rupee settles almost flat at 95.73 against US dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee stayed almost flat, ending just 1 paisa higher at 95.73 against the US dollar on Wednesday as a sharp rise in global crude oil prices amid heightened tensions in West Asia kept markets on edge.

Unabated selling in domestic equity markets put further pressure on the local unit, while RBI intervention and foreign fund inflows lent support. At the interbank foreign exchange, rupee opened at 95.72 and traded in a narrow range. It ended the session at 95.73, up 1 paisa from its previous close.

Gold falls Rs 800 in Delhi amid geopolitical uncertainty

NEW DELHI: Gold prices declined by Rs 800 to Rs 1,58,000 per 10 grams here on Wednesday as rising crude oil rates and lingering geopolitical uncertainty weighed on investor sentiment.

The yellow metal of 99.9 per cent purity had closed at Rs 1,58,800 per 10 grams on Tuesday.

Silver also declined, dragged by heavy selling, tumbling Rs 5,730 to Rs 2,35,000 per kilogram (inclusive of all taxes), from the previous close of Rs 2,40,730 per kg, according to the All India Sarafa Association.

Briefs

Narang to lead DSPAM's distribution

MUMBAI: DSP Asset Managers on Wednesday announced the appointment of Komal Narang as Head of Distribution, succeeding Usha Nair, who is retiring. Narang will lead the firm's distribution strategy and strengthen relationships with distribution partners. She joins DSPAM from JioBlackRock Mutual Fund, where she was Chief Client Officer. Narang has over two decades of financial services experience.

HSBC Midcap Fund: 18.92% CAGR in 22-yr

NEW DELHI: HSBC Midcap Fund has completed 22 years since its launch in August 2004, generating a 18.92 per cent CAGR since inception. A Rs 1 lakh lumpsum investment at launch would have grown to Rs 45.15 lakh by July 31, 2026. It delivered 17.83 per cent returns over one year and 23.17 per cent CAGR over three years.

DoT begins process to disband DCC

NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecom has reportedly begun the process of seeking Cabinet approval to dissolve the Digital Communication Commission, formerly known as the Telecom Commission, an apex inter-ministerial body on telecom policy and financially significant matters. It was formed in 1989 and helped in taking decisions on issues like spectrum price, call on recommendations by the TRAI.

EFFORTS TO BOOST CONNECTIVITY

Major infra push: Cabinet clears rail, highway projects worth Rs 13,041-cr

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 19

The Union Cabinet on Wednesday approved infrastructure projects worth Rs 13,041 crore, including four railway multitracking projects worth Rs 9,450 crore and an 83-km four-lane highway corridor in Bihar.

The railway projects on the Howrah-Chennai High Density Network will augment capacity, ease congestion and improve connectivity to industrial clusters, ports and freight routes. They cover Kharagpur-Bhadrak, Bhadrak-Haridaspur, Gummidipundi-Gudur and Cuttack-Paradeep. The 173-km Kharagpur-Bhadrak four-track project, costing Rs 3,352 crore, will pass through West Bengal's Paschim Medinipur and Odisha's Balasore and Bhadrak.

Railways Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said the project will improve freight connectivity between steel clusters at Jakhpura, Tatanagar and Durgapur and the Paradip and Dhamra ports. It is expected to enable 13 million



Railways minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

tonnes of additional freight movement annually, generate 59 lakh man-days of employment, save Rs 466 crore in logistics costs and cut CO2 emissions by 20.86 crore kg annually.

The Cabinet also approved a Rs 1,583-crore fourth line between Bhadrak and Haridaspur in Odisha. The 75-km section, covering Bhadrak and Jajpur districts, is operating at about 91 per cent capacity. The project is expected to raise freight capacity by 29 million tonnes annually, improve connectivity to Dhamra, Paradip and the proposed Subarnarekha ports, save Rs 433 crore in logistics costs and reduce CO2 emissions.

The 90-km Gummidipundi-Gudur third and fourth-line project was cleared at Rs 2,229 crore. Covering Tamil Nadu's Tiruvallur and Andhra Pradesh's Tirupati districts, the section has capacity utilisation of 131 per cent. The project will strengthen connectivity to Chennai, Kamarajar (Ennore) and Krishnapatnam ports and is expected to facilitate 21.24 million tonnes of additional freight annually. It will create 61 lakh man-days of employment, save Rs 382.15 crore in logistics costs and reduce CO2 emissions by 17.10 crore kg annually.

The fourth railway project, involving third

INSIGHT

- » The Union Cabinet approved four railway multitracking projects worth Rs 9,450 crore
- » It also approved an 83-km four-lane corridor between Muzaffarpur, Sitamarhi & Sonbarsa at Rs 3,591 cr

and fourth lines over 72 km between Cuttack and Paradeep (Badabandha), was approved at Rs 2,286 crore. It will connect Paradeep Port with the Howrah-Chennai network at Cuttack and provide better connectivity to the Kalinganagar steel cluster, Keonjhar's iron ore areas and Talcher coalfields. It is expected to add 12 million tonnes of annual freight capacity, save Rs 172.97 crore in logistics costs and reduce CO2 emissions by 7.74 crore kg.

The Cabinet approved an 83-km four-lane brown-field corridor between Muzaffarpur, Sitamarhi and Sonbarsa on NH-22 at Rs 3,591 crore. To be built

under the Hybrid Annuity Mode in 30 months, the project will include seven major bridges, three overbridges/underbridges, six vehicular underpasses and a bridge over the Bagmati River. Vaishnaw said the approvals were part of the government's wider infrastructure push. Under NDA 3.0, 62 railway projects worth Rs 2,74,176 crore, 38 highway projects worth Rs 3,82,119 crore and 12 metro projects worth Rs 1,46,444 crore have been launched.

The broader programme also includes airport and UDAN projects worth Rs 37,846 crore, port and shipping initiatives worth Rs 1,60,495 crore, and ropeway projects worth Rs 6,811 crore. Other allocations include Rs 71,193 crore for hydro projects and budget support, Rs 65,292 crore for industrial smart cities and parks, and Rs 5,36,137 crore under PM Awas Yojana. The government also earmarked Rs 8.7 lakh crore for Jal Jeevan Mission and substantial investments under semiconductor and electronics manufacturing programmes.

‘Manipulative’ trades during CAS on expiry day: Sebi bans 2 entities

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 19

Markets regulator Sebi on Wednesday barred two entities from the securities market and participating in equity Call Auction Sessions (CAS) after finding prima facie evidence of manipulative trading during the Sensex expiry-day auction on August 13.

In its first order related to the newly introduced CAS mechanism, Sebi said foreign portfolio investor Cophall Mauritius Investment Ltd and Mansi Share and Stock Broking Pvt Ltd adopted aggressive and opposite trading strategies

to influence the indicative equilibrium price (IEP).

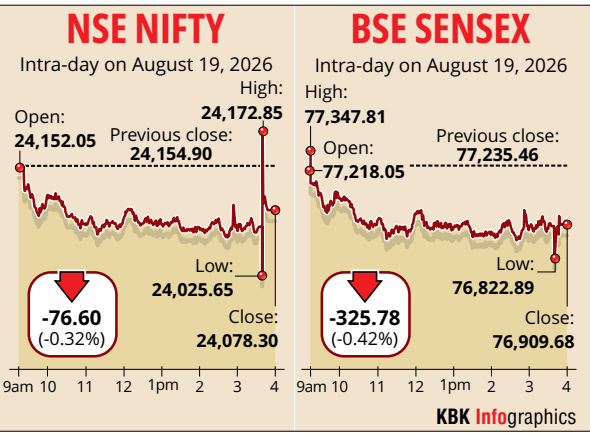
The regulator recorded three sharp Sensex movements of 362.02 points, 132.67 points and 405.08 points within two to 28 seconds. Cophall placed large buy orders in Sensex constituents at prices around three per cent above the reference price, accounting for 99.91 per cent, 96.09 per cent and 85.21 per cent of total buy-order value during the three spikes. Mansi, meanwhile, placed sell orders totalling 12.65 lakh shares across eight Sensex stocks below the reference price and cancelled the entire block

within seconds.

Sebi said the trading patterns needed to be viewed alongside the entities' expiry-day Sensex options positions. It prima facie calculated wrongful gains of Rs 2.96 crore for Cophall and Rs 71.64 lakh for Mansi. The regulator ordered the impounding of the alleged gains and restrained both entities from accessing the securities market and participating in equity CAS until further orders. Banks and depositories were also directed to restrict debits and transfers or redemption of securities from their accounts.

Nifty falls for 7th day, Sensex down 326 pts

Rising oil prices unnerv investors



MPOST BUREAU
Mumbai, August 19

Benchmark equity indices Sensex and Nifty closed lower on Wednesday as elevated crude oil prices amid a lack of a diplomatic resolution following the end of the US-Iran ceasefire dented investor sentiment.

Falling for the fourth consecutive day, the 30-share BSE Sensex dropped by 325.78 points, or 0.42 per cent, to settle at 76,909.68. During the day, it dropped 412.57 points, or 0.53 per cent, to 76,822.89. In the last four days, the benchmark has lost 1,170.28 points, or 1.49 per cent.

Extending its losses to the seventh day, the 50-share NSE Nifty declined 76.60 points, or 0.32 per cent, to end at 24,078.30. It has tumbled 505.5 points, or 2 per cent, in the last seven sessions.

The expiry of the temporary 60-day US-Iran ceasefire without any meaningful diplomatic breakthrough has renewed concerns over a prolonged disruption to energy supplies, driving crude oil prices higher. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 1.04 per cent to USD 91.97 per barrel.

From the Sensex pack, Power Grid, Bajaj Finance, Larsen & Toubro, ITC, Hindustan Unilever and Reliance Industries were among the major laggards.

HCL Tech, Eternal, Kotak Mahindra Bank and Sun Pharma were among the winners.

Broader markets also

THE EXPIRY OF THE TEMPORARY 60-DAY US-IRAN CEASEFIRE WITHOUT ANY MEANINGFUL DIPLOMATIC BREAKTHROUGH HAS RENEWED CONCERNS

declined as the BSE Small-Cap Select index dropped 0.73 per cent and Mid-Cap Select index by 0.01 per cent. Among sectoral indices, Power lost 1.69 per cent, followed by Capital Goods (1.59 per cent), Utilities (1.25 per cent), Industrials (1.15 per cent), Hospitals (0.89 per cent), Energy (0.68 per cent) and Commodities (0.62 per cent).

Housing Finance climbed 0.58 per cent, Focused IT (0.33 per cent), IT (0.27 per cent) and Mid-small Private Banks (0.03 per cent).

Asian markets endured one of their weakest sessions in recent months. South Korea's Kospi plunged nearly 6 per cent, triggering a trading curb, while Japan's Nikkei 225 fell more than 3 per cent as the recent technology-led rally reversed sharply under pressure from rising global bond yields and heavy selling in semiconductor stocks.

South Korea's Kospi tanked 5.80 per cent. Japan's Nikkei 225 and Shanghai's SSE Composite index also ended significantly lower, while Hong Kong's Hang Seng index settled marginally higher.

GAIL CMD inaugurates 3-month ‘Preventive Vigilance Campaign’

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 19

GAIL CMD Deepak Gupta on August 17 inaugurated the three-month Preventive Vigilance Campaign 2026 at the company's Corporate Office. The campaign, being observed as a precursor to Vigilance Awareness Week, focuses on strengthening integrity, transparency and good governance across the organisation.

Gupta highlighted this year's theme, "Probity for Prosperity", and

said integrity and ethical conduct were essential for sustainable growth, organisational excellence and public trust. He urged employees to actively participate in the campaign.

He said preventive vigilance should not be viewed merely as a compliance requirement but as a strategic and proactive approach to strengthening systems, mitigating risks and preventing irregularities.

The campaign will focus on five key areas – disposal of complaints, disposal of cases, capac-

ity-building programmes, digital initiatives and contract management. A series of workshops, awareness sessions and employee engagement activities will be conducted across GAIL offices and project sites during the period.

The programme was attended by GAIL directors Ayush Gupta (HR), Sanjay Kumar (Marketing), Rajeev Kumar Singhal (Business Development), S K Sinha (Finance) and Chief Vigilance Officer Rajnesh Singh, besides others.

E10 petrol may return alongside E20: Report ‘Exploratory discussions underway keeping older vehicles in mind’

New Delhi, August 19

The Centre has begun "exploratory discussions" with the automobile and fuel industries on whether E10 petrol can also be retailed alongside the E20 fuel, a media report said, citing sources aware of the matter.

The "preliminary" discussions, "keeping the older vehicles in mind", are being held on various technical and non-technical aspects of the country's complex fuel retail supply

chain, and no concrete conclusions have been arrived at yet, The Indian Express reported, quoting the sources.

The move comes amid growing concerns over the rushed rollout of E20 petrol, which contains 20 per cent ethanol, five years ahead of the earlier 2030 target. E10 contains 10 per cent ethanol.

Recently, Chief Economic Adviser V Anantha Nageswaran, in an opinion article, called for a lower ethanol-petrol blend to

THE ROW

- » The move comes amid growing concerns over the rushed E20 rollout
- » Over 80% of vehicles were not E20-compliant when the 20% blending mandate was introduced in the country

calm public concern.

The government said India achieved 20 per cent average ethanol blending in 2025-26 to

reduce crude oil imports, cut emissions and boost farmers' incomes. However, owners of pre-2023 vehicles, many of which are not E20-compliant, have raised concerns over reduced mileage and possible damage to engine components, particularly fuel injection systems.

Over 80 per cent of vehicles in India were not E20-compliant when the 20 per cent blending mandate was introduced, prompting demands for continued E10 availability.

The government has maintained there is no evidence that E20 causes engine damage.

The possible reconsideration of E10 has also intensified political criticism of the Centre's policy. Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav questioned the government's position after Nageswaran supported E10 for older vehicles. He asked whether the government or its adviser was correct and demanded the resumption of E10 sales for older vehicles. AGENCIES

Young Tan takes flight with Sen shocker



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 19

Young Garret Tan had already booked his flight out of India for Friday. He may now have to change it.

The 18-year-old American produced the biggest win of his young career on Wednesday, knocking out former World Championships bronze medallist Lakshya Sen 19-21, 21-19, 21-17 in a pulsating second-round encounter.

Tan had arrived at his maiden World Championships with little more than the ambition of playing his best badminton. He now has a place in the pre-quarterfinals and, at the very least, another day in New Delhi.

"I was supposed to leave on Friday, but I guess...", Tan said with a smile.

For a teenager making his World Championships debut, it was an extraordinary introduction to the biggest stage.

Tan did not spend hours studying Sen before the match. He preferred to keep the occasion, and the reputation of his opponent, at arm's length.

"No, not really. I just wanted to go in and just play my best. I didn't really want to think about who was standing in front of me," said Tan, who will face former champion Kunlavut Vitidsarn of Thailand next.

That simplicity appeared to work.

Ranked 92nd in the world, Tan played with the freedom of someone who had little to lose. He repeatedly found the rear court, used the drift intelligently and kept Sen uncomfortable with his attacking game.

"It's because of the drift and I just kept hitting that side," Tan explained.

His coach Paula Lynn, who has worked with Tan since he was a child, said the plan was to keep Sen away from the front court, where the Indian could put pressure on the young American.

"Lakshya is very good. On the first, he's putting a lot of pressure on Garrett in front. So that's why we wanted to keep him away from the front," Lynn said. Tan had hit his head and felt dizzy, an incident that reminded him of a similar episode a couple of weeks earlier.

"I went for the slide and then I hit my head a little bit and wasn't feeling really well because that happened in my previous match a couple of weeks ago and the same thing happened," he said.

millenniumpost
CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME
I, Aaliya D/o Salaudeen Saif R/o C-23, Gali N3 Wazirabad Village Burari Civil Lines, North Delhi Delhi-110084 declare that name of my father and mother have been wrongly written as Salaudeen Saifi and Jaida in my 10th class and 12th class Educational Documents. The actual name of my father and mother are Salaudeen Saif and Zaida which may be amended accordingly.

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
PUBLIC WORK DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR TENDER
Tender Notice No. 34 Year 2026-27

Sr.no	Name of work	Estimated Cost
1.	Construction of CC Road Leading to Madhu Dyeing in Bhiwandi Municipal Area Tal. Bhiwandi, Dist. Thane	1,26,29,151.00

1. Period of E-tenders :- Date. 21/08/2026 to Date. 31/08/2026
2. Date of Opening (If Possible) :- Date. 01/09/2026 at 17.30 Executive Engineer, P.W. Division No.1 Thane

1. Tender form Condition of Contract Specification and Contract drawing can be downloaded from e-tendering portal of public work Department of Maharashtra i.e. <https://mahatenders.gov.in>
2. Tender Notice can be seen also on website <https://mahatenders.gov.in> & www.w.mahapwd.com

No./TD/Tender/ 7932
Office of the Executive Engineer
P.W. Division No.1 Thane
Station Road
Date. 18/08/2026

Executive Engineer,
P.W. Division No.1 Thane
Dgipr/2026-27/2371

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E-mail: spkathua@jpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 11-07-2026, one person namely Saddam Hussain S/O Noor Mohd. R/O Bhamberwan Tehsil Marheene District Kathua lodged a written report at Police Station Rajbagh stating therein that on 26-06-2026 his wife namely Meena, age 19 years left the house at about 1000 hrs and did not return home till date. The complainant tried his best to search for his wife but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 16 dated 11-07-2026 has been entered at Police Station Rajbagh.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/Information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably-

DESCRIPTION ROLL

- Name: Meena
- Husband: Saddam Hussain
- Permanent Address: Bhamberwan
- Present Address: Marheene
- Tehsil: Rajbagh
- Police Station: 19 years
- Age: 5 feet 5 inch
- Height: Fair
- Complexion: Normal
- Built: Round
- Face: Black
- Eyes: Hindi/ Dogri
- Languages known: Hindi/ Dogri

Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311 (Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Rajbagh - 9103007512
5. SHO P/S Rajbagh - 9186316018

DIP No:DIP/J-8382/26

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

PHOTOGRAPH

GOVT. OF JHARKHAND
JHARKHAND FLYING INSTITUTE
CABINET SECRETARIAT AND VIGILANCE DEPARTMENT
(CIVIL AVIATION DIVISION)
STATE HANGAR, AIRPORT ROAD, HINOO, RANCHI
email - cad@jharkhandaviation.in ; govtffyops@gmail.com
Ref.No.-VI-Canteen (Misc.)/13/2026-चौकिया/610, /Ranchi/Date-17.08.2026

Notice

The Cabinet Secretariat and Vigilance Department (Civil Aviation Division), Government of Jharkhand invites bids through Government e-Marketplace (GeM) from eligible agencies/firms for Providing Canteen and Pantry Services at State Hangar, Ranchi. The details of tender can be seen in website <https://www.gem.gov.in> with GeM Bid Number-GEM/2026/B/ 7919423, Dtd.-14.08.2026. Interested bidder can submit their bid only through GeM Portal.

Sd/-
(Piyusha Shalina Dona Minz)
Under Secretary.

PR 387837 Civil Aviation(26-27)D

Noida New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B Nagar (U.P)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened / downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

S. No	Job no/Work name	Amount (Rs. in Lacs)
1.	12/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, D/o Park (C/o Pathway & Gazebo hut in Park, Sector-156) Noida.	93.97

Which can be uploaded by date 27/08/2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/ downloaded on date 31/08/2026 at 11.00 AM.

S. no	Job no/Work name	Amount (Rs. in Lacs)
1.	59/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27, M/o Park/Green Belt with two year Maintenance Sector-121 and 123 Noida	79.10
2.	60/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o RSP, Central Verge with two-year Maintenance Sector-63 All Central Verge Noida	75.57
3.	61/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27 M/o Parks/Green Belt (Annual Civil maintenance work of all parks and green belts in Sector-66, 67, 68 to Transport Nagar Sector-69) Noida	32.25
4.	62/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27 M/o Parks/Green Belt (Annual Civil maintenance work of all parks and green belts in Sector-57, 58, 59 to 60) Noida	51.10
5.	64/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27 M/o Green Belt (S/F of MS Grill in Boundary wall and other civil maintenance work in green belt along with 24.00 Mtr. Wide Road in Sector-67) Noida	34.89
6.	65/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Parks/Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance work of all parks and green belts in Sector-70, 71, 72, 73, 121 and 123) Noida	91.60
7.	70/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Green Belt (Beautification) C-Block Sector-62 with two year Maintenance Noida	79.69
8.	71/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park (Renovation of Gazebo hut & Finishing work in Different parks of Division-I) Noida	56.17
9.	73/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park (C/o of Footpath, Repair & maintenance of Boundary wall, Painting work in Different Location in Sector-18) Noida.	67.89
10.	74/D(H)/DD(H)-I/2026-27, M/o Park/Green Belt (Annual civil maintenance of all Parks and Green Belt in Sector-20, 22 and 23)	75.96
11.	40/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27 Annual maintenance of Parks & Green belts in sector -42, 43, 45 Noida.	66.53
12.	41/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27 Annual maintenance of Parks & Green belts in sector -48, Noida.	76.20
13.	42/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27 M/o Park (Re-Construction of footpath and gritwash of boundary wall near Arawali apartment sector-52) Noida.	71.11
14.	43/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27 M/o Green Belt (S/F of MS Grill above Outer Boundary wall and Fencing Concertina Coil for Safety purpose from B-1 to B-42 Sector-108) Noida.	68.93
15.	45/D(H)/DD(H)-II/2026-27 M/o Green Belt (R/o Boundary wall and Fencing Concertina coil near Mahamaya Inter Collage Sector-44) Noida.	50.24
16.	17 D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o RSP, Service Road & Green belt and along with Express Highway 05.00 Km to 10.00 Km R.H.S with two year maintenance.	98.82
17.	18/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o R.S.P Service Road & Green Belt And Along With Express Highway 00.00 Km To 05.00 Km L.H.S With Two Year Maintenance	98.05
18.	24/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o RSP & Green belt along with Express Highway 10.00 Km to 15.00 Km L.H.S with two year maintenance.	99.73
19.	26/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o Park, RSP & Green belt Sector-143, 143A & 143B With Two Year Maintenance	93.82
20.	27/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o Park, Green belt & RSP Sector-92 with two year maintenance.	81.95
21.	28/D(H)/DD(H)-III/2026-27, M/o Park/Green Belt (Annual Civil maintenance work in Dog Park, other parks and green belt in sector-137). Noida	43.02

Which can be uploaded by date 07/09/2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date 08/09/2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: Sector-39 Director (H) Noida

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY
1st Corrigendum
1st Corrigendum to the Tender Notice No. 435-ACS-C-SSB Dated: 13.08.26

Name of work: "Balance work for Construction of Dayabasti Grade Separator including earthwork blanketing, Retaining wall, PSC Girders, Steel Girders, Bridges and other misc. work etc. on Dayabasti Azadpur section under Dy. CE/C/SSB

The following changes/modifications are made to this office Tender Notice No. No.435-ACS-C-SSB Dated: 13.08.26. The pre bid conference will be held on 26.08.26 at 11.30 hrs to 12.30 hrs in the office of Dy. Chief Engineer/Const. / Northern Railway, Shakurbasti Delhi and though online VC link uploaded on IREPS. The other particulars of the Tender Notice and Tender Document as well, shall remain unchanged. 2883/2026

Serving Customers With A Smile

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE No.: T-16-N-2026-27 Date: 18.08.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (General) N.C. Railway, Agra on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through online only (E-Tendering) for the following works.

Tender No.: T-16-N-2026-27 Approx. Cost of the work: Rs. 3239476.03

Name of work with its location & Completion Period: Electrical work in connection with "Improvement of old and damaged wiring & other associated work at Kanha Rest House, Mathura . "

Completion period 08 months

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. Tenders can only be submitted through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs. on 11.09.2026. 1912/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGER!
TEMPORARY EXTENSION OF SHAKUR BASTI - PALWAL - SHAKUR BASTI EMU UPTO MATHURA JN. AND NEW DELHI - PALWAL - GHAZIABAD JN. EMU UPTO KOSI KALAN

It is notified for the information of rail passengers that Railways have decided to temporarily extend the run of Train No. 64016/64019 Shakur Basti - Palwal - Shakur Basti EMU services upto Mathura Jn. and Train No. 64082/64051 New Delhi - Palwal - Ghaziabad EMU services upto Kosi Kalan. The details are given below :-

Temporary Extension of Train No. 64016/64019 Shakur Basti - Palwal - Shakur Basti EMU upto Mathura Jn.					
Train No. 64016		STATIONS	Train No. 64019		
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.	
--	14:30	Shakur Basti	00:45	--	
No change between Shakur Basti to Palwal					
16:45	16:50	Palwal	22:15	22:20	
17:00	17:02	Rundhi	21:23	21:25	
17:12	17:14	Sholaka	21:11	21:13	
17:20	17:21	Banchari	21:04	21:05	
17:29	17:31	Hodal	20:54	20:56	
17:43	17:45	Kosi Kalan	20:40	20:42	
17:55	17:57	Chhata	20:28	20:30	
18:07	18:09	Ajhai	20:16	20:18	
18:19	18:21	Vrindavan Road	20:04	20:06	
18:30	18:32	Bhuteswar	19:53	19:55	
19:15	--	Mathura Jn.	--	19:45	

Date of Extension :
Train No. 64016 Ex Shakur Basti and Train No. 64019 Ex Palwal upto 31.10.2026 (Daily)

Temporary Extension of Train No. 64082/64051 New Delhi - Palwal - Ghaziabad EMU upto Kosi Kalan					
Train No. 64082		STATIONS	Train No. 64051		
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.	
--	--	Ghaziabad	01:40	--	
--	18:00	New Delhi	00:25	00:30	
No change between New Delhi to Palwal					
19:40	19:45	Palwal	23:00	23:05	
19:55	19:57	Rundhi	22:26	22:28	
20:07	20:09	Sholaka	22:14	22:16	
20:15	20:16	Banchari	22:07	22:08	
20:24	20:26	Hodal	21:57	21:59	
21:00	--	Kosi Kalan	--	21:45	

Date of Extension :
Train No. 64082 Ex New Delhi and Train No. 64051 Ex Palwal upto 31.10.2026 (Daily)

For detailed information regarding stoppages and timings of above train, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in
Download RailMadad app.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Your Convenience-Our Concern
Visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENGG-GSU-2026-09

Description of work: Construction of ROB in lieu of Level Crossing No.229 at km 1324/16-18 in between RPGU-BNAR stations in VGLJ-CNB Section & Construction of ROB in lieu of Level Crossing No. 367 at km 1128/20-22 at Jhansi Yard in BINA-VGLJ section in Jhansi division of North Central Railway.

Approx Cost (Rs.): 1248246316.59 | Earnest Money (Rs.): 24964900.00

Date of completion / period from issue acceptance letter: 18 Month

Date of closing Tender: 17.09.2026 * Tender online can be submitted up to 11:00 hrs. on 17.09.2026. * For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1920/26 (PH)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Khush S/o Kailash Kumar R/o E-189, Lajpat Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No.180/2020 U/S 188 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Khush** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Khush** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Khush of FIR No.180/2020 U/S 188 IPC, PS Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **29.09.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11480/ON/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Azgar Hussain @ Kalu S/o Late Abul Hussain R/o Gaddha Colony, Pradhan Garden Near Madina masjid Madanpur Khadar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 335/2025 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Azgar Hussain @ Kalu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Azgar Hussain @ Kalu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Azgar Hussain @ Kalu** accused of **FIR No. 335/2025 u/s 25/54/59 Arms Act at P.S. Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order: Sh. Manuj Kaushal,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, (South-East)
Room No. 512,
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/11682/SE/2026

UJVN Ltd.
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O. "UJJWAL" Maharani Bagh, CMS Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone-0135-2763808 Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvn.com

RO No. 704
TENDER NOTICE
Date: 19.08.2026

Office of the Executive Engineer, (M&G) Mohammadpur Power House, Gurukul, Narsan -Haridwar invites sealed tenders from experienced firms for following works/supply for Mohammadpur Power House:-
NIT No. 08/EE(M&G)/MPH/2026-27

1. Name of work - Maintenance Works of Machine no 2 of Mohammadpur Power House.
2. Estimated Cost: Rs. 17,25,288.00 (GST extra)
Date of availability of bid document on website: 20.08.2026
Last date for submission of tender: 11.09.2026, up to 15:00 Hrs.
For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website www.ujvn.uk.gov.in.
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (M&G)
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Shekhar S/o Jagdish R/o E-27, Chitrkoot Colony, Rishi Nagar, Bhagpat Road, U.P.** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 90/2007 U/s 368/371/411/34 IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Shekhar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Shekhar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Shekhar of case FIR No. 90/2007 U/s 368/371/411/34 IPC, P.S. Rajinder Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.11.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Central District, Room No. 150
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11398/CD/2026 (Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 28/2026 Dated: 18.08.2026
E-Procurement Tender Notice

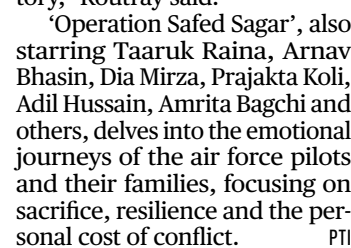
On behalf of the President of India, Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-Procurement tenders:

S. N.	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	EMD (Rs.)
1	19266884A	ELASTIC RAIL CLIP(ERC) MK-V WITH FLAT TOE FOR 60KG UIC/52KG ETC.	618220 Nos.	12,03,580/-

Tender Opening Date:- 10.09.2026

Note: (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on IREPS website i.e. <http://www.ireps.gov.in> (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III Digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entry in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. The above tender notice has been uploaded on <http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>. In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1907/26 (MG)

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल,सिमडेगा
Email Id rrdsd.simdega@rediffmail.com

सूचना

सूचित किया जाता है कि इस कार्यालय द्वारा आमंत्रित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या RDD /SD/SIMDEGA /02/2026-27 PR No. 386125 Simdega (26-27)_D को अपरिहार्य कारणों से अगले आदेश तक रद्द किया जाता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता,
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल,
सिमडेगा
PR 387856 Simdega(26-27).D

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	13/26-27/WE
Name of work with its location	Construction of a boundary wall to prevent encroachment in a densely populated areas in the section of Sr. DEN/Estate.
Approx. Cost of Work	4,69,73,093.58
EMD Amount	9,39,500.00
Completion Period of Work	12 Months
Date and Time for Submission of Tender and Opening of Tender	Closing date of tender on 11.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Website particular notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No.: 128-W/269/O.E.T./NIT No. 13/26-27/WE	Dated: 18.08.2026 2891/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

Tender Notice No. 19-Elect/G/PRYJ/2627 Dated: 18.08.2026

(ELECTRICAL GENERAL SERVICES)

E-TENDE NOTICE

Senior Divl. Electrical Engineer/Gen/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tenders on prescribed form for the following works upto 15.00 hrs. on 11.09.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:-

SN: 1	TN: ELG-48-2627	Cost of work (In Rs.): 57,00,673.53
Name of work: Electrical works in connection with Interlocking of 10nos. mid-section non interlocked LC Gates in branch lines over Prayagraj division. Ambiapur-Tundla: Construction of RUB at LC No. 19 at Km. 1132/5-7 in AAP-TDL Section		
Bid Security (In Rs.):	1,14,000.00	Duration of Completion : 06 Months
SN: 2	TN: ELG-49-2627	Cost of work (In Rs.): 77,12,480.40
Name of work: Electrical work in connection with the work of "Pd Deen Dayal Upadhyay Junction - Proposal for 30 bed Running Room & Lobby at DDU (Deen Dayal Upadhyay Junction)". Electrical work in connection with "Pd Deen Dayal Upadhyay Junction Ghaziabad PRYJ DIV: Construction of changing rooms for women force members at 21 RPF posts of Prayagraj division".		
Bid Security (In Rs.):	1,54,300.00	Duration of Completion : 06 Months
Tender Opening date: 11.09.2026, 15:00 Hrs.		
Note:- 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tender is available on Website www.ireps.gov.in upto 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening.		
North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR 1913/26(K)		

यूनियन बैंक ऑफ इंडिया
भारत सरकार का उपयुक्त
A Government of India Undertaking

UNION BANK OF INDIA
Noida Sector 15 Branch,
Address at - Sector - 15, Opposite Nirula's Hotel, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201301

Appendix-IV

POSSESSION NOTICE
RULE 8(1) OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT RULES)2002 (FOR IMMOVABLE PROPERTY)

Whereas the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of Union Bank of India, under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement Security Interest Act, 2002 (S&REI Act) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 had issued Demand Notice dated 05.06.2026 calling upon the borrower(s) & Guarantor(s) namely, M/s Nahid Enterprises through Proprietor, M/s. Seema Naz, At : A-227, sector-69, Transport nagar, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P.-201301, Also At: H.No. 112, 3rd Floor, Gyan Khand-3, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad-201014, Also At: H. No. 134, Gyan Khand-3, Indrapuram, Ghaziabad-201014 to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice being Rs.25,28,457.61 (Rupees Twenty-Five Lakhs Twenty Eight Thousand Four Hundred Fifty Seven and Sixty One Paisa Only) as on 31.05.2026 together with interest within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

The borrower(s) & Guarantor(s) having failed to repay the amount, Notice is hereby given to the borrower(s) & Guarantor(s) and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under Sub-Section (4) of Section 13 of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on this the 14th day of August, 2026.

The borrower's attention is invited to provisions of Sub-Section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

The borrower(s) in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the Union Bank of India, Noida, Sector-15, Opposite Nirula's Hotel, Noida, Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201301 for an amount Rs.25,28,457.61 (Rupees Twenty-Five Lakhs Twenty Eight Thousand Four Hundred Fifty Seven and Sixty One Paisa Only) as on 31.05.2026 in the said accounts together with further costs, interest and expenses.

DESCRIPTION OF MOVABLE PROPERTY

Hypothecation by way of first and exclusive charge over entire current assets of the firm (both present as well as future) including Book Debts and Stocks in trade by the Borrower in favour of the Bank.

Date: 14.08.2026
Place: New Delhi

Sd/- Authorised Officer
Union Bank of India

UJVN Limited
(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)
H.O.: "UJJWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephones: 0135-2763808, Fax: 0135-2763508
CIN No. U40104UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvn.com

दिनांक: 19/08/2026

पर सं: 707

"e-Procurement"
e-Tender Corrigendum Notice-04

Due to unavoidable reasons, the date of submission and opening of the following tender invited by the Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Dharchula is extended as follows.

Tender Notice Reference: NIT No.: 03/EE (Civil-SHP)/ Dharchula/ 2026-27.

Last date & Time for submission of Tender on the Portal: up to 17:00 hrs. of 03.09.2026

Last Date & Time of Receipt of relevant document in Office: up to 17:00 hrs. of 05.09.2026

Date & Time of Opening of Tender on the portal: at 15:00 hrs. of 07.09.2026

For the eligibility and other detailed information, the e-procurement portal "<http://uktenders.gov.in>" keep watching continuously.

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Neeraj Chaturvedi S/o Ramesh Chand R/o H. No. 144/1 Hari Nagar Ashram New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in CT Case 735/2021, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Neeraj Chaturvedi cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Neeraj Chaturvedi has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Neeraj Chaturvedi in CT Case 735/2021, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 21.09.2026.

By order
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 512
DP/11604/SE/2026
Saket Court, New Delhi

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)

Sr.DMM, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the president of India invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items.

Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing date
93260056	Hydraulic Re-Railing equipment	01 No	28.09.2026

Note:- 1. Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details.
2. No manual offer will be entertained.
Sr. DMM/NS/LP/93266056/2026 Date: 18.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 2878/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Sunita Sharma @ Shruti Sharma D/W/o Vijay Sharma R/o C-2/242, 1st Floor, Sector 16, Rohini, Delhi has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 442/2018 U/s 323/451/506/427/34 IPC, P.S. K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Sunita Sharma @ Shruti Sharma cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Sunita Sharma @ Shruti Sharma has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Sunita Sharma @ Shruti Sharma of case FIR No. 442/2018 U/s 323/451/506/427/34 IPC, P.S. K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.09.2026.

Sh. Aakash Sharma
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North District, Room No. 213
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11576/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

SOUTH INDIAN Bank
Experience Next Generation Banking

The South Indian Bank Ltd
Regional Office - Delhi,
3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21st, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh,
New Delhi - 110005. Phone - 011 4233 1664/
011 4512 8661, email - ro1008@sib.co.in.

E - AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. Borrowers/Builder/Developer/Land Owners

1. Mr Rajendra Pratap Singh, S/o Mr Nidhan Singh, 2074, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075. Also at, H No MM-52, Ground Floor, DLF Phase 2, Gurgaon, Haryana -122008. Also at, Plot No 1062, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075. Also at, Flat No 1062, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075.

2. Mrs Swaita Singh, W/o Mr Rajendra Pratap Singh, 2031, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075. Also at, H No MM-52, Ground Floor, DLF Phase 2, Gurgaon, Haryana -122008. Also at, Flat No 1062, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075. Also at, 2074, Sanskrit Apartments, Plot No 35, Sector 10, Dwarka, New Delhi -110075.

3. M/s Magic Info Solutions Pvt Ltd, Reg Office at, D-13, Defence Colony, New Delhi -110024. Also at D-155, Basement, Defence colony New Delhi-110024.

4. M/s Godrej Projects Development Pvt Ltd, Reg Office at, Godrej One, 5th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East), Mumbai -400079.

5. Mr Manoj, S/o Ajit Singh, Represented by M/s Godrej Projects Development Pvt Ltd, Godrej One, 5th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East), Mumbai -400079. Also at, Mr Manoj, Represented by Power of Attorney holder M/s Magic Info Solutions Pvt Ltd, D-13, Defence Colony, New Delhi-110024. Also at, Godrej Summit, Sector 104, Gurugram, Haryana -122006. Also at D-155, Basement, Defence colony New Delhi-110024.

6. Mr Rajhans, S/o Baljeet Singh, Represented by M/s Godrej Projects Development Pvt Ltd, Godrej One, 5th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East), Mumbai -400079. Also at, Mr Rajhans, Represented by Power of Attorney holder M/s Magic Info Solutions Pvt Ltd, D-13, Defence Colony, New Delhi -110024. Also at, Godrej Summit, Sector 104, Gurugram, Haryana -122006. Also at D-155, Basement, Defence colony New Delhi-110024.

7. Mrs Sheela Devi, W/o Ajit Singh, Represented by M/s Godrej Projects Development Pvt Ltd, Godrej One, 5th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East), Mumbai -400079. Also at, Mrs Sheela Devi, Represented by Power of Attorney holder M/s Magic Info Solutions Pvt Ltd, D-13, Defence Colony, New Delhi -110024. Also at, Godrej Summit, Sector 104, Gurugram, Haryana -122006. Also at D-155, Basement, Defence colony New Delhi-110024.

8. Mr Sukbir Singh, S/o Bhim Singh, Represented by M/s Godrej Projects Development Pvt Ltd, Godrej One, 5th Floor, Piroshanagar, Eastern Express Highway, Vikhroli (East), Mumbai -400079. Also at, Mr Sukbir Singh, Represented by Power of Attorney holder M/s Magic Info Solutions Pvt Ltd, D-13, Defence Colony, New Delhi -110024. Also at, Godrej Summit, Sector 104, Gurugram, Haryana -122006. Also at D-155, Basement, Defence colony New Delhi-110024.

(Name of Property Owner) Mr Rajendra Pratap Singh

Description of property All that part and parcel of residential flat bearing no A-1703 admeasuring to 457.54 Sq mtr (4925 sq. Ft) in the 16th Floor of Tower-A, Apartment Complex-'Godrej Summit', along with proportionate undivided interest and rights in the common areas and land and exclusive right to use and occupy 2 covered car parking space, and all other rights existing and appurtenant thereon in Sector 104 situated at Gurgaon Village, Gurgaon District, Haryana and bounded on : North : Open East : Open South : Entry, Passage facing Flat No.A-1702 West : Open

Reserve Price Rs. 4,00,00,000/- (Rupees Four Crore Only)

Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) Rs. 40,00,000/- (Rupees Forty Lakhs Only) (EMD shall be deposited on or before 19.09.2026 till 02.00 PM)

Bid Increment amount Rs. 1,00,000/-

Date and time of E-auction 22.09.2026 from 11.00 AM to 11.30 AM (With 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www.southindianbank.com. Details also available at <https://bankauctions.in>

For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Manesar, New Delhi on 7447766757.

Date : 19.08.2026 | Place : Delhi Sd/- Authorised Officer (Chief Manager)

COURT NOTICE
(U/O 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Aashima Garg
Civil Judge (Junior Division),
BAHADURGARH
Hosiyari Devi
Vs.
Hawa Singh
EXE-49/2025
CNR No. HRJRAO-000928-2025
Next Date 19-09-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:
Bailliff/Authorized officer by the Court
:-
BAHADURGARH
In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 19-09-2026 at 10:00 am.
1. Def. Deepak S/o Late Sh Sukhvinder
2. Def Ashish S/o Late Sh Sukhvinder
For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=distict_notice&district=Jhajjar
Sd/- Ms. Aashima Garg
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
dated 19-08-2026
BAHADURGARH

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Corrigendum Notice No. 6120262027-135
Date : 17.08.2026
Cancellation Notice

The above-mentioned work was scheduled to be opened on 02.09.2026 vide Tender No. 135 of Tender notice No. 6120262027 dt 07.08.2026 is cancelled due to administrative reason. 1842/26 (MG)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR

CHANGE OF NAME
I, G.P.S. VERMA, Presently known as Gaurevender Pal Singh Verma, Son of Kanchi Lal Verma aged about 50 years, resident of D-25/3, Madhuban Mohalla, street No. 2, North Ghonda, Delhi-110053 do hereby solemnly affirm and declare as under : That my name was earlier recorded and mentioned as " G.P.S. VERMA" in certain documents/ records. That my full and present name is " Gaurevender Pal Singh Verma", I have changed my name from G.P.S. Verma to Gaurevender Pal Singh Verma for all future purposes. I also Declare that G.P.S. Verma and Gaurevender Pal Singh Verma are that same and one person.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref: Tender Notice No. 21/2026-2027 dated 19.06.2026 S. No. 03 Tender No. 77269045RGC Opening date 21.07.2026.

In reference to above, tender opening date already extended from 21.07.2026 to 21.08.2026, now this is second corrigendum, tender opening date has been extended from 21.08.2026 to 21.09.2026. All other terms and conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

Note: This is the second Corrigendum in above referred tender.
Date: 18.08.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 2881/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Murgan S/o Sh. Elumalan R/o 28/383, Trilokpuri, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 218/2017 U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC Act., has been registered at PS: Mayur Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Murgan cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Murgan has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Murgan of under FIR No. 218/2017 U/s 377/506/498A/406/34 IPC Act., Registered at PS: Mayur Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 22.09.2026.

By Order
Ms. Ritika Kansal
JMFC (Mahila Court), Room No. 24
Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/11660/ED/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Kundan S/o Ravi Shankar R/o H. No. D-309, Near Post Office Village Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 172/2021 U/s 33 D. Excise Act PS: Bawana, Delhi. and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Kundan cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Kundan has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Kundan accused of FIR No. 172/2021 U/s 33 D. Excise Act PS: Bawana, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 22.09.2026.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
JMFC-05, Room No. 114
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11589/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Md. Chand, S/o: Md. Islam, R/o: H.No. 190, F Block, JJ Colony Bawana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 97/21, U/s: 33 D.EX ACT, PS: Bawana, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Md. Chand, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Md. Chand, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person Md. Chand, of FIR No. 97/21, U/s: 33 D.EX ACT, PS: Bawana, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 07.10.2026.

By Order
Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11380/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Mohd. Afzal S/o Md. Iqbal, R/o H. No.-467, Block-L, Sunder Nagri, Nand Nagri, Delhi, Also at -H. No. B-196, Behta Hazipur, Loni (U.P.), has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 481/2024, U/S 304(2)/35(3)/17(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Jyoti Nagar, North-East Distt., Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mohd. Afzal cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mohd. Afzal has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that Mohd. Afzal the said accused of FIR No. 481/2024, U/S 304(2)/ 35(3)/17(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS Jyoti Nagar, North-East Distt., Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Rahul Saini
Judicial Magistrate First Class-08, Room No. G-7,
Shahdara Distt., New Court Building,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/11611/NE/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Hemker Jha S/o Udit Naryan Jha R/o H. No. 360/09, Haddo Mohalla Madanpur Khada, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 562/2016 U/s 279/338/304A IPC & 185/146/196/56/192 MV ACT, PS Sarita Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Hemker Jha cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Hemker Jha has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that Hemker Jha in FIR No. 562/2016 U/s 279/338/304A IPC & 185/146/196/56/192 MV ACT, PS Sarita Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 05.10.2026.

By order
Dr. Aneez Bishnoi
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (South East)
Main Court Building, Court Room No. 510
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi

DP/10025/SE/2026

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC0826
E-Tender Notice

Deputy Chief Engineer(Construction), North Central Railway, Agra Cantt for and on behalf of the President of India invites in TWO PACKET SYSTEM open tender on prescribed forms online (E-Tendering). Tender offer can be submitted on line up to 15.00 hours of 10.09.2026, on website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: E-Tender Notice No. CEN00AGC0826 Approx Cost: Rs. 49.65 Cr. (App.)

Description of work: Construction of ROB (End to End) in lieu of Level Crossing No. 358 in Mathura Achnera section.

Earnest Money Rs.: 99,31,700/- Completion Period: 18 Months

Date of opening: 10.09.2026 Validity: 90 days

Note:- For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. 1897/26(K)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused (1) Rohan @Nicky S/o Sh. Bharat Chawla (2) Shweta Passi W/o Dheeraj Passi R/o D-1/134 sector 16, Rohini, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 341/2015 U/S 420 IPC PS Rani Bagh, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused (1) Rohan @Nicky (2) Shweta Passi cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused (1) Rohan @Nicky (2) Shweta Passi has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made (1) Rohan@Nicky (2) Shweta Passi in FIR No. 341/2015 U/S 420 IPC PS Rani Bagh, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.09.2026.

By order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/10153/OD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Bhaskar Eknath Tate S/o Sh. Eknath Tate R/o H. No. M-34-A, Malviya Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 152/2021 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Bhaskar Eknath Tate cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Bhaskar Eknath Tate has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Bhaskar Eknath Tate accused of FIR No. 152/2021 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act PS: Kashmiri Gate, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 25.09.2026.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
JMFC-11, Room No. 138, First Floor
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/11265/N/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
T. Notice No. GSU/Elect/PRYJ/E-Tender Notice/2026/71 Dated: 17.08.2026
E-TENDER NOTICE

Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer/GSUN.C. Rly/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite the following E-Tender, the details of the tenders are as under:-

Tender No.: GSU-EL-WC-80R-2026

Description of work : 25 kV OHE modification work due to (1.) Provision of Advance Trip Maintenance Centre at Electric Trip shed PRYJ (2). Provision of Advance Trip Maintenance Centre at Electric Trip shed, at CNB W/L & GMC area in Prayagraj division.

Advertised value: Rs. 31836849.81 Bid Security: Rs. 636700.00

Completion Period: 12 Months Bidding system: Single Packet

Tender Closing date & Time: 09.09.2026 & 14:00 Hrs

Tender opening date & Time: 09.09.2026 & 15:00 Hrs

Note: (1) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders shall be available on Website www.ireps.gov.in in 21 days prior to the date of opening of the tender. (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate. (3) In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 1895/26 (D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONCR

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Notice No. 2026-Aug-03 Dated : 17.08.2026
E- Tender Notice

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N. C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

S.N.: 1. Tender No.: 2026-Aug-03-01 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 3,34,69,993.25

Description of Work: Construction of relay huts for gate signaling at all non-interlocked level crossing (16 nos.) having TVU>10000 at remaining LC gates of Agra Division.

S.N.: 2. Tender No.: 2026-Aug-03-02 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 54,99,479.53

Description of Work: Replacement of Stone Slab Bridge by RCC Box culvert at Bridge No. 147 at Km 80/12-13 in IDH-BK1 Section.

S.N.: 3. Tender No.: 2026-Aug-03-03 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 8,77,39,635.22

Description of Work: Provision of 50 rooms (100 beds) at NDLS for decongestion at MSRR NDLS due to existing dormitory rooms (Composite work- Civil+Electrical).

S.N.: 4. Tender No.: 2026-Aug-03-04 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 99,99,470.20

Description of Work: Mathura Jn.- Upgradation of C&W Depot Buildings and associated infrastructure at MT J.

S.N.: 5. Tender No.: 2026-Aug-03-05 Approx. Cost (₹) : ₹ 1,47,48,400.09

Description of Work: Balance work of: - Miscellaneous P-Way work in SSE/PW/SIAGC & SSE/PW/DHO section under ADEN/DHO for a period of 01 Years.

Note: For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15.00 hrs. on 07.09.2026. 1891/26 (MG)

North central railways CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Ankit Giri, S/o: Devilal Giri, R/o: Village Dilippur, Purana Bazar, Thana Kashai, Tehsil Raniganj, District Pratapgarh, U.P., also at Gali No. 9, Damja Block, Jain Nagar, Begampur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 695/2015, U/s 279/304 A IPC, P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ankit Giri cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ankit Giri has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ankit Giri accused of offence in case FIR No. 695/2015, U/s 279/304 A IPC, P.S.: Shahbad Dairy, Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 21.09.2026.

By Order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11511/ON/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
Letter No.: DRMC/AGRA/NFRE-AUCTION Dated: 17.08.2026
E-AUCTION NOTICE

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager - North Central Railway- Agra invites E-Auction as per category given as under:-

Category: ADVT Catalogue No.: ADVT-IDH-26-07

Asset Details: Commercial Publicity via Glowsign / Board at Platform & Concourse area of Idgah Railway Station.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date: 31.08.2026, Time: 11:00

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date: 31.08.2026, Time: 11:30

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit E-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot- Wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1888/26 (PH)

North central railways CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



AROUND THE WORLD

- » Union Education Minister reviews implementation of PM's free online coaching initiative
- » Odisha announces scholarship for students seeking overseas education
- » IIT Madras research leverages public sequencing data to uncover global patterns of marine microbial community assembly
- » Nagaland University celebrates 80th Independence Day at Lumami



BUZZER ROUND

Q) Which Prime Minister of India had the shortest tenure at office?

Send us your replies to careersmp22@gmail.com. We shall publish the names of the first 3 correct entries in next week's edition

Answer to our Aug 13 edition question: **Roopa Unnikrishnan**

Correct answers were sent by: **Mallika Ghosh, Soham Kundu, Deepak Halder**



NEWS & VIEWS

IIT Madras Prof Thalappil Pradeep has become the third Indian to be elected as a full member of the European Academy of Engineering (EAE), headquartered in Gothenburg, Sweden. There are several Nobel Laureates, Fields Medallists and Turing Award Laureates as members of the academy.

Mahindra University announced the launch of India's second HackerFab, following the student-led HackerFab at IIT Bombay, and the first university-sponsored, student-led open-source semiconductor fabrication facility. The initiative strengthens the university's contribution to India's semiconductor ambitions.

NEARLY 6 IN 10 PROFESSIONALS SAY THEIR JOB TITLE DOESN'T MATCH THEIR PAY: SURVEY

Professionals value career recognition, but increasingly expect it to come with a better salary

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Rohit Karmakar had been looking for a job change for nearly two years. When he finally moved to a new company, he also stepped into a more senior role. However, the salary hike he received was far from satisfactory. Nearly six in 10 professionals say their job title does not reflect their compensation, revealing a growing disconnect between recognition and reward in India's workplaces.

A recent survey found that nearly 80% of professionals believe title inflation has become common across industries, with many observing colleagues carrying increasingly senior designations that are not always matched by comparable compensation.

Nearly one in three professionals who received a title change over the past two years say it came with either no salary increase or an increment of less than 5%. At the same



stronger title improves how potential employers perceive them. 57% also say their designation has a significant impact on their overall job satisfaction. Together, these findings suggest that employees continue to value titles, but increasingly expect them to be backed by meaningful compensation and genuine career progression.

The employer perspective offers important context to this shift. 57% of employers say their organisation uses senior-sounding or enhanced job titles to some or a great extent to attract or retain talent. This signals that designa-

tions are increasingly being used as a strategic talent lever alongside compensation. For many organisations, designations have become an increasingly important tool to attract candidates, retain high-performing employees and recognise growth, particularly when salary budgets remain constrained. Employers also cite evolving market expectations and changing organisational structures as factors driving the use of more senior titles.

The findings suggest that employers and employees are often looking at the same promotion through different lenses. While organisations view titles as one of several ways to recognise talent, employees continue to associate career progression most strongly with financial advancement. This expectation gap is shaping how professionals evaluate opportunities, measure success and define meaningful growth in today's labour market.

For many organisations, designations have become an increasingly important tool to attract candidates, retain high-performing employees and recognise growth, particularly when salary budgets remain constrained

time, 52% of professionals say they would choose a higher salary over a better designation when considering a new opportunity, suggesting that while titles may open doors, compensation continues to define career value.

Interestingly, the survey also shows that professionals are not dismissing titles altogether. Nearly 70% believe their designation plays an important role in shaping future career opportunities, while almost 73% feel a

IIT Bombay launches e-PG Diploma in Computer Science and AI



OUR CORRESPONDENT

IIT Bombay has launched an e-Post-graduate Diploma in Computer Science and Artificial Intelligence (CS and AI) for professionals and graduates looking to enhance their expertise in computer science and AI.

Offered under IIT Bombay's Educational Outreach initiative, the programme has been introduced against the backdrop of the growing integration of artificial intelligence with computing. It is aimed at software developers, engineers, IT professionals and data scientists who have either studied computer science at the undergraduate level or gained relevant expertise through professional experience. Fresh graduates with a basic foundation in computer science

can also apply. The programme will be designed and delivered by IIT Bombay faculty, with EdTech company Great Learning serving as its partner. It will cover core computer science concepts alongside emerging areas in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning.

The e-PG Diploma will feature a blend of synchronous and asynchronous online learning, complemented by an in-person campus immersion at IIT Bombay.



ADMISSION ALERT

EXECUTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMME IN HR ANALYTICS FROM XLRI JAMSHEDPUR

OUR CORRESPONDENT

XLRI Jamshedpur has opened admissions for Batch 9 of its Executive Development Programme in HR Analytics, designed to equip working professionals with practical capabilities in evidence-based people management and workforce decision-making.

Participants will learn to capture and clean data, develop customised HR metrics, select appropriate analytical models and interpret quantitative and qualitative findings. Applications across staffing, attrition, training, performance management, compensation, leadership, organisational culture and organisational development will also be covered.

The application-oriented pedagogy includes live lectures, case studies, analytical exercises,

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Duration: **Eight to nine months**
- » Delivery: **Live direct-to-device sessions**
- » Campus immersion: **Six mandatory days across two phases**
- » Programme commencement: **Oct 9-11**

assignments, tutorials, peer-group work and faculty-led discussions. Participants will also undertake an HR analytics project based on an organisational requirement and receive faculty feedback.

The programme is suitable for HR business partners, talent-acquisition professionals, learning and development practitioners, HR operations executives, people-analytics professionals, HR consultants and other professionals involved in workforce decisions.

Indian Museum, SNU sign MoU to promote heritage & museum studies



OUR CORRESPONDENT

In a significant development, the Indian Museum, Kolkata, signed an MoU with Sister Nivedita University (SNU) for the promotion of heritage and museum studies. Recently, the Indian Museum in collaboration with SNU organised 'Viksit Bharat 2047 and Partition Horrors Remembrance Day 2026'. The MoU is expected to provide a structured

framework for academic cooperation and engagement in areas related to heritage and museum studies. Such collaboration can facilitate opportunities for students and faculty in areas such as academic interaction, research, museum-based learning, heritage awareness and knowledge exchange.

The programme also witnessed the gracious presence of Maxim Kozlov, Consul General of the Rus-

sian Federation in Kolkata, and Dr Natalia Gerasimova, eminent historian, whose participation added an international and scholarly dimension to the occasion. Dr Sayan Bhattacharya, Director, Indian Museum, Kolkata, Satyam Roychowdhury, Chancellor, Sister Nivedita University, Prof. (Dr.) Dhruvjayoti Chattapadhyay, Pro-Chancellor, Sister Nivedita University and others were present at the event.

UNIVERSITY DISCUSSES FREEDOM & RESPONSIBILITIES OF YOUNG CITIZENS

St Xavier's University Kolkata remembers Partition of Bengal through academic programmes

OUR CORRESPONDENT

St. Xavier's University, Kolkata (SXUK) observed August 14, 2026 as a Day of Remembrance of the Partition of Bengal through a series of academic programmes focusing on the historical, social, cultural and economic impact of Partition, as well as the courage and resilience of those affected.

As part of the observance, the Xavier's Students' Board organised an Inter-Departmental Debate, moderated by Dr Sovik Mukherjee. The discussion encouraged students to engage critically with the circumstances surrounding Partition and its wider political, social and economic consequences. The team comprising Swastika Roy and Damayanti Datta, representing the Faculty of Arts and Social Studies, was declared the winner.

The observance continued with a panel discussion, which explored the experiences of displacement, loss, and suffering, along with the social, cultural, economic



and psychological consequences of the Partition.

The institute also celebrated the 80th Independence Day at the campus. The celebration commenced with the hoisting of the National

Flag by Vice-Chancellor, Rev Dr John Felix Raj, in front of Britto House in the presence of faculty and students, followed by the collective singing of the National Song and the National Anthem.

Emphasising the role of education and young citizens in nation-building, the V-C, in his address, highlighted the importance of enlightenment, critical thinking and values in giving true meaning to freedom. He called upon students to uphold the spirit of "Nation First" and contribute responsibly to the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, reminding them that "Freedom is a continuous journey, not a final destination."

The programme also witnessed the distribution of prizes to the winners of various competitions organised by the Xavier's Students' Board. Prizes were presented to the winners of the Inter-Departmental Debate, organised in observance of August 14 as a Day of Remembrance of the Partition of Bengal.

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